Bounty

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/58223821.

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Not Rated

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Original Characters

Additional Tags:
Magicat Catra (She-Ra), Adora is She-Ra, Catra is on the Hunt, No one realises Adora is She-Ra, yet - Freeform, They are both after a serial killer, Shapeshifter, Catra is sort of a bounty hunter, without the bounty, Catra likes Adora, Maybe love later

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by masternoveller

Summary

Catra is chasing after a shapeshifter serial killer.
Will the BFS be helpful or a hinderance?

Notes

It's a short chapter to start with as I test out the waters with this new fic.
It's always more fun when I'm writing multiple fics and getting my brain to brain...
Also I'm on holidays for the next two weeks... so I guess I'll have time to write until the wee hours of the morning...

See the end of the work for more notes

Stoned Angel

"Hey! Get back here!" Catra shouts as she chases after the small child running away from her through the crowded marketplace of Bright Moon's bustling streets on a warm and sunny morning, the peace completely broken by the magicat sprinting through, trying not to trip over the obstacles being knocked over in the child's attempt to flee from her, "Hey!"
"Leave me alone, you creep!" The child shouts back, panting heavily as they push through the many legs in front of them, before they reach a small clearing and the child looks around at their surroundings in a panic before they centre their attention on a blonde woman looking at a few ornamental swords on display, "Help!" They shout as they barrel into the blonde, "Help me! Please!"
"Hey… you're okay." The blonde woman smiles down at the child, cradling them against her thigh, "What's wrong?"
The child, dressed in blue overalls with pink hair and an innocent looking face, glances around then points to the approaching magicat with short and ruffled hair, dressed in dark brown cargo pants, matching long sleeve button up shirt that's wrinkled and a maroon vest, on her belt is a small dagger with a sword on the other side, "Her! She's trying to get me!"
The blonde stands up straight and spots the magicat, her brows furrow as she draws her sword and holds it out in front of her, pushing the child behind her protectively before speaking, "Stay back, whoever you are."
Catra scoffs, "Give me the kid."
"No." The blonde says and then gestures, "Go. Get out of here."
"No way." Catra growls out, "The kid is mine. I'm taking them away before they kill more people."
"Kill?" The blonde repeats as she looks down briefly at the child who hugs onto her leg, before she shakes her head, "You must be mistaken. There is no way this child is a killer."
"That *kid* is no child." Catra spits back, "Listen, princess…"
"Adora." The blonde corrects sharply, "Don't call me princess."
"Whatever, princess." Catra huffs out, "Give me the kid. I don't

want to have to mess up that pretty face of yours."
Adora smirks, "You think you can take me?"
"Yeah." Catra shrugs as she draws her own sword out and brandishes it in front of Adora, "Would be a shame to scar that pretty face, wouldn't it?"
Adora chuckles cynically, "You have no idea who I am, do you?"

"You're Adora apparently. And not a princess." Catra shrugs again, "Now, move out the way. That kid is dangerous."
The child blows a raspberry at the magicat before hiding behind Adora once more.
"I'm going to give you one more chance, cat…" Adora starts.
"It's Catra." This time the magicat corrects Adora before adding mischievously, *"Princess."*
"Fine, Catra." Adora starts over, "I'm going to give you one more chance. Leave this child alone. Or I will have you arrested."
"Look, princess Adora or whatever." Catra growls out irritated, "Give me the kid. They are not innocent. They've already killed 2 people. And they are only just getting started."
"You're crazy!" The child shouts out before quickly hiding back behind Adora, tugging on her pants, the blonde looks down as they say, "She's been trying to kidnap me. She's been following me for days… I think she wants to… to…"
"What is it?" Adora gently pats them on the shoulder, "What does Catra want to do to you?"
"Touch me." They whisper out.
"What?!" Catra shouts out in shock, "I do *not* want to touch you!"
People around stop and stare at the magicat's sudden outburst, hearing only the last bits of the conversation. Adora glares at the magicat, "You sick…"
"I am not a paedophile!" Catra protests loudly, "I'm not!" She looks around at the crowd like she's trying to convince them before glaring down at the child that smirks at them briefly before going back to their innocent demeanour, "You little…"
"Hey! Back off!" Adora holds Catra back, the tip of her sword pressing a little into Catra's chest, "I'm warning you."
Catra growls again, "And I'm warning you. You're making a huge mistake."

“Back off.” Adora repeats.
Catra looks down at the blade poking into her chest and then back at Adora, “Go ahead, kill me.”
“Don’t tempt me.” Adora narrows her eyes at the magicat, “And don’t try anything stupid.”
Catra laughs, “Hate to burst your bubble, princess. But I don’t do anything but stupid.”
Adora looks thoroughly confused at that statement, so much so that Catra manages to get her off balance and snatches up the child and begins to run off. The blonde rights herself with a huff, before taking off after the magicat while the child starts to scream and cry out for help.
“Come back here!” Adora shouts after Catra, “For the Honour of Grayskull!”

“You little piece of shit.” Catra grunts as she struggles to hold onto the child in her arms, “Did you really think I wouldn’t catch up with you, Stone? You can shapeshift all you want, and I can still find you.”
“Yeah, yeah, yeah.” Stone bites down on Catra’s arm making the magicat howl out in pain, releasing the small childlike person in her arms, the shapeshifter grins before spitting out the little bits of Catra’s fur, “Yuck. Your blood is disgusting.”
“Good.” Catra grips her arm, “I hope it kills you.”
“Ha!” Stone laughs out loud before suddenly quietening back down to their timid demeanour from before when a much taller and glowy figure steps forward, a familiar sword in her hands as her blonde hair whips around to a phantom wind, Stone smirks at Catra once more before running with open arms towards this woman, “Help me! Please!”
“Stay behind me, little one.” The glowing woman tells Stone and the shapeshifter sticks their tongue out at Catra.
“You little piece of shit!” Catra tries to rush to child again, only to be pushed back and off her feet by the blonde woman, groaning as she tries to gets up, “Who the fuck are you?”
“She-Ra!” A smaller woman with pink hair bursts out of the crowd, followed by a dark skinned man with a bow and arrow in his hands, aiming straight at the magicat, “What’s going on?”

“She-Ra?” Catra repeats as she looks at the blonde woman, “No way…”
“Yes way.” She-Ra narrows her eyes at Catra, “Leave this child alone.”
Catra pushes herself off the ground, brushing herself off before holding up her slightly bloodied arm, “That *child* is no innocent that needs saving. As I told that blonde princess before, Stone is a killer.”
“Stone?” She-Ra looks down at the child.
“I’m not Stone.” Stone lies making Catra growl loudly at them, “My name is Angel.”
“Ha! Like hell you are!” Catra scoffs out loudly, much to the ire of everyone around looking at the so very innocent ‘child’ hugging at She-Ra’s leg, “Quit playing around and surrender!”
“Glimmer. Bow.” She-Ra addresses the newcomers, “Get Angel to somewhere safe while I deal with this… magicat.”
The pair usher ‘Angel’ away and out of Catra’s sight, “You’re making a huge mistake.” Catra pauses, “Wait… what the fuck is this? Deja vu? I’ve already said this to that Adora girl…”
She-Ra doesn’t respond, instead stepping forward and towering over the magicat who just stares up at her, “Leave. Before I throw you out.”
“Yeah… not going to happen, She-Hulk.” Catra grins as she ducks between She-Ra’s legs and makes a run for it, only to be pulled back by the scruff of her neck, “Ow! What the fuck!?”
“You just don’t learn, do you?” She-Ra sounds very disappointed, and it makes Catra feel somewhat conflicted between laughing out at her and … guilt. “I warned you before.”
“What can I say?” Catra grunts out as her feet dangle above the ground, “I’m a slow learner.”
“You… hey!” She-Ra loses her grip on the magicat who manages to twist and turn out of her grip and starts to sprint away on all fours and back through the crowded marketplace with ease, “Come back!”
She-Ra gives chase… again.

“There you are you little shape shifting shit!” Catra catches up to Glimmer and Bow, shoving Bow out of the way and then dodging

the loose swinging staff from Glimmer, "Woah! Careful there, Sparkles! You might actually hit me."
"That's the point!" Glimmer grunts out, swinging wildly at Catra with her staff, "Let Angel go!"
"Angel is Stone!" Catra dodges the strikes, holding Stone up as a small shield to deflect the oncoming blows, "And Stone is a stone cold killer!"
"Yeah right." Glimmer rolls her eyes, "That sweet child is not a killer!"
"That sweet child *is* a killer!" Catra corrects as she ducks under another swing of Glimmer's staff, "And! This isn't a child! Oof!"
"Stay down. I don't want to hurt you!" Bow says with his arrow pointed down at the magicat that he has just floored, "Give us Angel."
"No." Catra says defiantly, "Stone needs to pay for their crimes."
"I've done nothing wrong! I'm innocent!" Stone tries to struggle free, but Catra keeps her grip on them, "Let me go! Stop touching me you creep!"
"Fuck!" Catra yowls out again as they sink their teeth into the same arm, "You little…"
That momentary slip of focus has Stone ripped out of Catra's arms and she's all of a sudden lifted up by the collar of her already wrinkled shirt and once again has her feet dangling above the ground by She-Ra, "You like touching children, is it?"
"What?! No!" Catra grips onto She-Ra's wrists, "Don't believe them! Stone is a shapeshifter! I'm telling you the truth!"
"You're a bad person!" Angel spits out at Catra and the magicat tries to lunge at them, only to be held in place by She-Ra, the child then pulls on Glimmer's hand, "Make her go away!"
Glimmer nods to Angel, "She-Ra. Lock her up. We can't have her threatening other children."
"You're making a huge mistake!" Catra shouts out as She-Ra carries her off and away from Stone, "They'll kill! They will! And then that blood will be on your hands!"
"Enough!" She-Ra grabs Catra and brings her close enough that their foreheads are almost touching, "Stop."
Catra just growls in response as She-Ra carries her away before dumping her into a cell.

“Stay.” She-Ra points to the magicat as she walks out the door, shutting and locking it behind her.

Catra looks around her cell and chuffs, “Swanky.” She flops down on the rather comfortable and soft bed, enjoying the fact that she can actually melt into it and then closes her eyes, mumbling, “I’m safer in here than anyone out there.”

Catra’s sensitive ears pick up the sounds of screams in the early hours of the morning as she rolls over onto her back, followed by the sounds of sirens and a hive of activity that seem like it’s all happening just outside her so called, cell. She waits for the footsteps and the banging on the doors to come, but it doesn’t happen.

Not right away.

First, the sounds of shouting and arguing start from a far away. The voices get louder and then they get closer and Catra knows the footsteps are now approaching and the banging on the door will follow very soon.

Nope. No banging on the door.
The door swings open, almost coming off its hinges as Catra winces at the sound of it nearly falling off but remains calm and flat on her back with her eyes closed.

“You!” Someone shouts, it must be Sparkles or Glitter or whatever her name was, “You did this!”
Catra ignores the accusation, turning over and with her back to the sparkly girl, her tail flicking in irritation.
“Hey! I’m talking to you!” Glimmer shoves the magicat so she’s on her back, an accusing finger pushed into Catra’s chest as she growls out, “This is all your fault!”
Catra waves Glimmer’s finger off of her, keeping her eyes shut, the magicat just says, “I was right, wasn’t I?”
“Glimmer!” Adora pulls her friend back as Bow pulls the smaller

woman into a hug.
“A family, Adora…” Glimmer starts to sob, “They killed a child!”
“I know.” Adora pats her friend on the shoulder as Bow hugs her harder, trying to calm her down as Adora sighs, “We need to find Angel.”
“Stone.” Catra corrects from where she’s still laying down.
Adora hugs both of her friends before pulling back, “Go. We need to find Angel before they target more people. Send out pictures of them and have everyone on alert.” The blonde turns back to the magicat, “I’ll interrogate the prisoner.”
Catra snickers at that description as Bow and Glimmer leave the room.
“Something funny, Catra?” Adora stands over the magicat, arms crossed over chest as she glares down at Catra.
Catra slowly sits up, “Yeah. I think you owe me an apology.”

Defence

Chapter Summary

Does Catra get an apology?

Chapter Notes

Quick update! Enjoy!

Also CW - Violence, Blood and Gore etc.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Well. Go on. Apologise. Tell me I'm right. I know I'm right." Catra goads, wincing as the muscles on her arms twitch and hurt from the two separate bite marks from Stone, "Also, some medical attention would be nice, not to mention I haven't even been fed since being in here."
Adora glares at the magicat, "They killed a young family last night."
"Yeah." Catra shrugs, "Yet… I'm the one in here, stripped of my freedoms."
The blonde slumps down, her hands balling into fists as she whispers out, "I'm sorry."
"What was that?" Catra's ears flicker around, "I didn't quite catch that."
"I'm. Sorry." Adora repeats louder, "You… you were right. And… I… we should have listened to you."
"Great." Catra hops up off the bed and to her feet, "Can I go now?"
"What?" Adora seems thoroughly confused, "You're just going to go?"
"Someone's going to need to get that little shapeshifter shit, Stone." Catra looks around and then back at Adora, "I'm going to need my weapons back too, princess."
"Just like that?" The blonde furrows her brows.
"Yes. They've already killed 5 by my count." Catra grabs one of

the bedsheets and rips it up to make a makeshift bandage as Adora winces at the sound, the magicat finishes wrapping up her arm before looking back at Adora, "What?"
"If you needed first aid, you should have said something." Adora tells her with a sigh.
"You literally dumped me in here and then no one came back to check on me until Sparkles nearly broke the door down to yell at me." Catra replies flatly, "Or were you expecting me to escape?"
"Oh." Adora mouths the word and then turns to the magicat, "No one came?"
"No." Catra's stomach growls, "Now, where are my weapons?"
"They are in my room." Adora admits before her eyes widen at the admission, "I mean, I'll go get them."
"Should I come with you?" Catra asks with a smirk, "I'm sure your bed is probably ten times better than this one in here."
"You… what? Want to come to my room?" Adora's voice goes up an octave.
"Did I stutter?" Catra eyes her with a shrug, "Yeah, I want to see your room."
"Why?"
"Wow. Guess I really will be doing something stupid later." Catra mutters under her breath before answering Adora normally, "Yes. Show me your room. Also show me the kitchen. I'm fucking starving."
Adora huffs a little annoyed as she turns to walk out, the magicat getting a great view of the blonde's ass as she follows behind. Adora seems to notice and glares at the magicat, "Quit staring at my ass and hurry up."
"Geez, sorry, princess." Catra makes up the gap and walks beside the blonde, "Also where's the good booze?"
"Excuse me?" Adora frowns down in front of them.
"Booze. Alcohol." Catra clarifies despite the fact that she knows that's not what Adora's train of thought was on, "Figured you guys owe me for wrongful imprisonment. But hey, I'm not fussy. I'd be happy with a night with you and a case of brew."
"You are not getting a 'night' with me." Adora scoffs.
"Two nights then. A week is the longest I'm planning to stay so a week with you wouldn't be so bad." Catra shrugs and waits for the

reaction she knows she's going to get, holding back the twitching in her lips to laugh.
"That is not part of the deal. I'm not part of the deal." Adora stops to emphasize the point, "And you are not getting any 'booze'."
Catra shrugs again, "We'll see about that."
"No, we will not." Adora turns around a little flustered at how confident Catra seems to be in thinking she'd be so easy to bed, "Come on. Get your stupid weapons and then you can get Stone."
"What about food? Or first aid?" Catra enquires seriously, "I'm injured and I'm fucking hungry and you and your dumbass friends think I'm going to go after Stone on an empty stomach, injured and well, well rested, but that's beside the point."
"What is your point?" Adora groans out as they turn a corner.
"My point is," Catra looks around, "Where the fuck are they taking me?" The magicat looks around, "There is no way a princess like you lives on the bottom floor where they keep the cells and the service people."
"Infirmary." Adora replies with an eye roll, "To get your arm looked at."
"Oh, cool." Catra straightens up, "Hopefully that little shit drank my blood and dies."
"Is your blood poisoned?" Adora looks over at the magicat seriously, "Because if magicat blood is poisonous, I need to let the healers know."
"No. My blood is not poison. I'm projecting." Catra huffs, "That little shit bit me. Twice!"
Adora's can't help the small smile that appears on her lips as she quickly tries to school her face back to neutral, "Come over here and sit down. I'll get the healer over to look at your arm and… redress it. And you can stop ripping up the bedsheets."
Catra holds up her bandaged up arm, "Well, I wouldn't have had to rip them up in the first place if you told me I'd get patched up first."
Adora is about to retort when she looks over and sees a mischievous grin on her face knowing that the magicat was just riling her up. Instead, she pouts involuntarily, crossing her arms over her chest feeling a little defeated, "Well… I didn't know."
"You saw that twerp bite me. Twice." Catra rolls her eyes, "Or did

you think I was just being dramatic?"
"I didn't think that!" Adora protests before grimacing, "It didn't help that you weren't exactly forthcoming…"
"Ha! Don't make me laugh." Catra says as a healer appears and starts to take off the bedsheet bandage and cleans the wounds making the magicat hiss at how cold the ointments feel on her fur, "Woah, that's cold…"
Adora giggles this time at the magicat's reaction, quickly covering her mouth as she does so and then clears her throat, "How were we supposed to know Angel…"
"Stone."
"Stone." Adora corrects herself, "How were we supposed to know that *Stone* was really a shapeshifting serial killer?"
"Because I fucking told you." Catra grunts out before shaking her head, "Why doesn't anyone ever believe me?"
"Well, would you believe you?" Adora throws back at her, "It was you against what we thought was a child."
"That I fucking told you was a shapeshifter serial killer." Catra reiterates and then holds up her good arm, "Look, we can keep going around in circles with who is right, which I am, but at the end of day you guys fucked up. And you should be fucking on your knees begging for my forgiveness right now."
"I'm not getting on my knees and begging you for forgiveness." Adora dismisses that notion quickly, "I'm not getting on my knees at all for you."
"We'll see." Catra grins back, "But… just putting it out there… I'd be happy to be on my knees in service of you… or behind you…"
The healer gasps audible, stopping their treatment upon hearing this conversation as Catra laughs while Adora blushes.
"What makes you think I'm even interested?" Adora says feeling her face heat up.
"Oh, you are definitely interested." Catra says with such confidence that it even surprises herself, "And if you were wondering… I'm extremely interested too."
The healer coughs as they quickly finish off working on Catra's arm and excuse themselves.
"Did I say something?" Catra asks with genuine confusion on her face as she looks at Adora whilst the healer quickly makes their

exit, “Did I offend them?”
“No. I don’t think so.” Adora replies looking over Catra’s arm, “People here aren’t so… open to that kind of… conversation.”
“You mean talking about sex?” Catra clarifies and Adora nods with a blush, “Oh… is that like a big thing here?”
‘What do you mean?”
“Do people just not talk about it or something?” Catra prods a little more and then drops her voice down to a whisper, “Are we not allowed to talk about it?”
Adora shakes her head, this conversation is really making her flustered as she tries to reply, “Well, it’s not that you can’t talk about it… it’s just, uh, well, people don’t usually talk about… it…”
“Sex.” Catra grins as she happily supplies the word.
Adora nods, biting her bottom lip, “Um, yeah. That.”
“You can say the word, you know?” Catra stands up from where she was seated and moves her arm around, making sure the new dressings weren’t too tight, before shrugging, “Are you really not interested?”
Adora just stares back at the magicat’s question, unable to answer as Catra moves forward until they are barely apart, the magicat leaning in and grins when she hears Adora’s breath hitch, “I… I can’t.”
“You can’t?” Catra repeats a little confused, “You… can’t be interested?”
“That’s… that’s not what I meant.” Adora sighs, “Whatever you think is between us, isn’t there. So, nothing is going to happen. It can’t happen.”
“Okay.” Catra says slowly, taking a step back, “My apologies Adora for being so forward then. But, if you change your mind…”
“I won’t.”
"If you do, change your mind, that is. Well, I’ll be around, I guess.” Catra says, “Well, for the rest of the week anyway.”
“Well, in any case.” Adora decides to change the subject, “Your weapons?”
“Oh, right. Lead the way princess.” Catra gestures for Adora to go ahead.

“Okay, here we are.” Adora stops at her door, hesitating for a moment, “Wait out here and I’ll go grab your stuff.”
“Can’t I come in?” Catra asks, a glint in her eyes.
Adora clears her throat, “Uh… okay. But… no funny business.”
“I’m not funny.” Catra replies, “And I’ve got no business to attend to, not in your room anyways.” Catra grins as she says the next part, “Not yet.”
“Not ever.” Adora rolls her eyes as she opens the door.
“We’ll see.” Catra adds as she follows Adora inside her room, “Woah… why do you have water fountain in your room?”
“It’s just there.” Adora replies heading straight for her bed as Catra tilts her head at the blonde, watching as Adora bends over and reaches under her bed to retrieve the magicat’s weapons and when she stands back up with them in her hands she sees Catra just staring at her, “What?”
Clearly caught, Catra coughs, “Sorry. I shouldn’t be gawking at you.”
Adora narrows her eyes at Catra before holding out the weapons, “Here. Take them.”
“Thank you.” Catra reaches out for them and puts them back on her belt, looking around Adora’s room once more, “Am I getting fed or…?”
“What do you want to eat?” Adora asks and almost immediately regrets it when Catra just smiles back at her, “No. I am not on your menu. Quit it.”
Catra laughs, “Okay, okay. I’ll stop.” The magicat stifles her laughter and then walks over towards the window, pushing it open before turning back to Adora, “Well, princess. Until we meet again.”
“Hey! Where are you going?” Adora calls out as she heads over to where the magicat is looking out the open window, “You’re not leaving through there, are you?”
“Uh, yeah. I am.” Catra leaps up onto the windowsill, “I think I can see Stone’s trail of destruction.”
“Where?” Adora pulls Catra back in briefly, “I don’t see anything.”
“You wouldn’t.” Catra shrugs Adora’s hand off her and gets back up on the sill and looks around again, this time spotting where Stone’s signature mark is, “Okay. Thanks for the… uh, whatever

this was. Until next time, princess."
And before Adora can stop her, Catra's leapt out of the window and down the side of the castle, dropping to the ground and then running off into the distance.

"Stone! Come back here you little shit!" Catra growls out as she shoves the shapeshifter into a wall.
"Little? Who are you calling little?" Stone stands up to their full height, the shapeshifter no longer in the body of a child but now stands at the same height as She-Ra, hair now green and long, draped over a lithe reptilian frame, their eyes remain the same as when they were embodied a child as they tower over the magicat, "I'm at 5. Think you can stop me?"
Catra draws her sword out and starts to attack, Stone dodges left and right easily as the magicat continues to advance, "Fight me!"
"Hm…" Stone pretends to think, "Ow!"
Catra manages to slash Stone in the side as the killer springs backwards, "That was 1 for me. Next one I won't miss."
"Says the one that got thrown into a cell by She-Ra." Stone spits back as they turn and start to run off into town, "Catch me if you can!"
"Fuck." Catra takes off other them as the shapeshifter shifts into the form of young pretty woman, adorned with a white dress and carefree hair, "Great…"
"Help me!" Stone cries out as they run into the arms of a group of men gathered in a bar, "Help me! She's trying to kill me!"
A big muscly man steps forward, he's covered in tattoos with a shaved head and a beard, pushing Stone behind him, whilst his friends get up from their seats, leaving their drinks on the bar, "Hey!"
"What?!" Catra growls back as she shoves the big tattooed man out of the way, "She's not who you think she is!"
"Back off, you animal!" Another man shouts as Stone smirks briefly over to Catra, "Leave the girl alone!"
"She's not a girl! Or innocent!" Catra growls out, lunging forward trying to grab Stone, only to be flung back, "Oof! Fuck… this is bad…" she mutters under her breath and stands up, "You will all

regret this."
The men all laugh as Stone leans into the big tattooed man, the shapeshifter whispers something into the man's ear and he grins, turning to his friends, "Looks like we've got a fun night ahead of us, fellas!"
The rest of the guys cheer as Catra shakes her head, "You idiots are all going to die."
"What? By you?" The man laughs as another one picks up Catra and throws her out the window, the group of guys laughing loudly as the music in the bar turns up to an excruciating level and Catra pins her ears back as she rolls over from her side from the harsh landing, glass shards strewn around her as she lies flat on her back, catching her breath.

"Are you okay?" A familiar and sweet voice asks as Catra opens her eyes and grins up, "I heard… screaming."
"Hello to you too, Adora." Catra grunts as she sits up, shaking out the glass from her fur and clothes, "You can add another… I'm going to say… 5 to Stone's tally."
Adora holds her hand out and Catra grasps it as she's pulled up to her feet, "Are you serious? 5 more? Why didn't you stop them?"
"Couldn't." Catra shrugs as she feels around the back of her head for any blood and then almost hisses when she feels Adora's hand on her face, "What?"
"You're bleeding. Here." Adora runs her thumb around the gash on the magicat's forehead, "Do I need to bring you to a healer again?"
"Only if it means you get to keep touching me." Catra says before she turns back to the bar where Stone had taken refuge earlier, "I don't think Stone's there anymore. The scent is gone."
"What happened?"
"Stone shapeshifted into a *very* attractive woman and then spouted a bunch of lies and well, I got thrown out the window and said 'fuck it.'" Catra answers, "So, yeah. Arrest me or whatever since I just let it happen."
Adora watches as Catra offers her wrists to get cuffed, "I'm not arresting you."

Catra drops her arms, "I'm hungry."
"Okay."
"Okay?"
"Yeah, okay." Adora agrees, "But… we need to check to see if Stone has left anyone alive. Even if they probably deserved it…"
"I'll do it. You don't need to see it." Catra offers, "I'll holler if there's anyone alive."
"Are you sure?" Adora asks watching the magicat head towards the bar.
"Yeah. Just… stay here." Catra gestures for Adora to stay where she is, "There's no need for both of us to see… that."

Catra walks inside the bar and is hit with the smell of dead bodies and excrement, the magicat almost gags as she sees the destruction Stone's caused. They've really gone all out on all these guys that had defended them earlier.
"Ugh… gross…" Catra puts her elbow over the face to try to stop breathing in the smells, "Fucking Stone…"
Catra bends down to inspect one of the men that seems to be more… intact, than the others. She nudges him with her foot and there's no response except for this head dislodging from his body as the magicat steps back and watches it roll around a little.
As she inspects the last of the bodies she looks up and over the bar is a message, written in the blood of those slain.

You'll never catch me, Hunter.

"Fuck you, Stone." Catra grunts at the message before taking a still sealed bottle of beer and walking out, popping the cap off as she gets to Adora, "Make that 7, not 5. The little shit also killed the barkeep and his wife."
"That's terrible!" Adora says, "They've killed 12 now."
"Yep. Though 5 of them kind of deserved it…" Catra starts before backtracking, "…is what I would say if it wasn't all such a tragedy for them…" To top that off, Catra grins, teeth and all looking extremely cheesy and guilty at the same time.
Adora shakes her head, a small smile on her lips as she sighs, "I

need to inform Glimmer of this."
"Sparkles? Why her?" Catra takes a step back, "She's going to fucking try to whack me with that stupid stick again."
"*Glimmer* is sorry." Adora explains, "And so is Bow."
Catra looks away with a shrug.
"And…" Adora puts a hand on shoulder and gives it a gentle squeeze, "And so am I."
"Whatever." Catra says, "Doesn't change the fact that she still thinks it was my fault."
"She doesn't think that. Not anymore." Adora replies, "It… it was just the shock of it all."
"I get it." Catra puts her hand on Adora's hand on her shoulder, "I wouldn't trust me over a sweet looking innocent child either. Because apparently I look like a kidnapper and a paedophile."
"Which you are neither." Adora breathes out, "I… shouldn't have been so quick to judge."
"I look forward to how you plan on making it up to me." Catra chides, looking up with a mischievous grin, before clearing her throat and her sudden and fleeting confidence, "Or perhaps you can get me some food to go with my beer."
"You stole that." Adora points out.
"I did no such thing." Catra takes a sip from the bottle, "The barkeep and his wife are both dead. And not to mention it was in the hand of one of the recently deceased misguided men that fought a losing battle against a shapeshifter, which I would be led to believe had been paid for." Another sip, "And thus, since the drink has been paid for and the holder of this drink now deceased, I believe it became fair game." Catra sculls the rest of the bottle and then sticks out her tongue, "Plus I paid my price."
Adora quirks an eyebrow not understanding.
"It's warm." Catra says, "Warm beer, Adora. Beer should not be warm."
"What's wrong with warm beer?"
"I… I don't know where to start." Catra shakes her head in disgust, "Beer is supposed to be cold." When Adora just looks at her with a blank face Catra rolls her eyes and sighs, "Okay, why are you going to tell Sparkles?"
"Glimmer, if you haven't realised is the Queen of Bright Moon."

Adora says like Catra should know that, “And as Queen of Bright Moon, serial killers running around here is pretty high on her priority list. She needs to rid this… Stone.”
“Great. Then feed me, fix me and then let me find and get rid of them.” Catra suggests, “I don’t even need payment unless you are offering yourself to me. Otherwise I’ll get paid when I bring them back.”
Adora narrows her eyes at the magicat, “Who are you, Catra? Really.”
“I’ve already told you who I am.” Catra replies as she puts the empty bottle down on the ground and then turns around to walk away, “I’m just after my bounty.”

Chapter End Notes

Hm... maybe starting my holidays with late night writing is probably not the best way to get my sleeping patterns back to normal...
But, then when would i write? 🙃

Thanks for reading, kudos and commenting!

Tells

Chapter Summary

Stone taunts the pair a little more.

Chapter Notes

Ah, yes!
A new chapter!
Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“You can stop following me, princess.” Catra grumbles as she tries to shake the blonde off her tail, “I work alone.”
“Yeah, and look where that got you.” Adora scoffs, “If we are going to get Stone, we have a better chance if we work together.”
“No.” Catra turns and stops to face Adora, “Stone’s mine. And I’ll be damned if you steal my bounty.”
Adora frowns back at the magicat, “That’s all you care about? Getting paid?”
“And laid.” The magicat smirks before adding, “Why else would I be doing this?” Catra shrugs after.
“To stop a serial killer.” Adora deadpans like it should be obvious, “Would you even care if it wasn’t a bounty hunt?”
“Nope. Probably not.” Catra replies nonchalantly much to the dismay of the blonde staring back at her in disbelief before the magicat add, “Uh, mostly because I probably wouldn’t even know about Stone or their killings.”
“Oh.”
“Yeah.” Catra chuckles awkwardly while rubbing the back of her neck, “But, since I do plan to get my bounty, I don’t need a hero or a sidekick with me.”
“Well, too bad.” Adora crosses her arms over her chest, “You’ve got one. A hero, that is. Not a sidekick. Obviously, I am not a sidekick.”
“No.” Catra simply replies, turning back around and starts to walk

away.
“Yes.” Adora quickly catches up to the magicat.
“No.” Catra pauses for a moment.
“Yes.” Adora repeats as she tries to reach out to put her hand on Catra’s shoulder, “Hey! Come back here!”
Catra grins as she evades Adora’s touch, swivelling out and then sprinting in the opposite direction, “Good luck finding Stone, princess!”
And before Adora can even turn into She-Ra, Catra’s leapt up and out of sight as the blonde grunts out in frustration, screaming out, “Catra!” in vain.

“Well, well, well. If it isn’t the bounty hunter.” Stone taunts the magicat leaning back in a chair at the local tavern, “Aren’t you supposed to be out trying to catch me?”
Catra looks at the serial killer in the form of a young blonde man, their scent giving them away and then scoffs out, “Well, you’re right here.”
“I am.” They quirk an eyebrow before quickly taking a step back when Catra stands up from her chair.
“Why aren’t you running?” Catra leans in and narrows her eyes, she’s definitely feeling a little tipsy, damn, why did she drink 3 beers already...? Oh right, she got 2 of them free from the nice cute woman in the corner of the bar.
Stone can see that their bounty hunter is not on her game and smirks, “I doubt you’ll be able to catch me in your drunken state.”
They look her up and down and shake their head, “You’re drunk, hunter.”
“You’re only saying that because I literally have a beer in my hand.” Catra snarks back, taking a sip of her drink, “And…”

CLICK

“Look at that.” Catra looks down with a grin on her face as she slaps a handcuff over Stone’s wrist and clicks the other end to herself, “Looks like I caught you.”
Stone looks down at their now cuffed wrist, “You really think this

is going to stop me?"
"No. I know it's not." Catra takes another sip, "But it was funny to see the look on your face."
Just as Stone is about to snark right back, Adora appears and the shapeshifter grins, "Looks like your girlfriend is back. Reckon I can make her jealous?"
"Ha!" Catra laughs out sarcastically, "Like I would go for a dude." Another sip, "And, she's not my girlfriend."
"Loser." Stone taunts the magicat who just glares right back at them as Adora comes over, the shapeshifter clearing their throat, "Oh, hello! Any chance you can tell this asshole to uncuff me?"
Adora looks between the two of them as Catra just stares back at Adora with a shrug, "What is going on? Who are you?"
Catra looks at Stone and then back at Adora, "Who do you think it is, princess?"
Adora looks at the cuffed young man standing next to Catra, "Uh… Stone?"
"Ding ding ding!" Catra nods, before grinning out and then shouting out, "Give the girl a prize!"
"You're Stone?" Adora narrows her eyes at them.
"Shapeshifter." Stone bows, "Pleasure to meet you again."
"You're under arrest for murder." Adora tells them seriously, "You'll be coming with me back to Bright Moon to face the full force of the law."
"Oh, that's not going to work for me." Stone replies with a smirk.
"They aren't going back to Bright Moon. I'm taking this dipshit back to get my bounty." Catra cuts in, finishing her drink and then placing it on the table, swaying a little in the process, "Sorry, Adora. I need this more than you."
"No way." Adora frowns, "Stone is coming back with me."
"I caught this jackass." Catra slurs out, "Mine. My bounty. Go back to your castle, princess."
"Catra. You're drunk." Adora breathes out, pinching the bridge of her nose, "How about this… Stone comes back to Bright Moon with me and *Queen* Glimmer can reimburse you that bounty."
"There's nothing Sparkles can give me in Bright Moon." Catra returns before focusing her eyes on Adora, "Why are you here? How did you find me?"

“It wasn’t exactly hard.” Adora rolls her eyes before elaborating, “I just looked in the first tavern I came across. Figured you were after a cold beer since the one from before was warm.”
“See. You’re a drunk. Even blondie agrees with me that you’ve got a drinking problem. And probably some other problems too.” Stone chastises the magicat, “Now, take off these cuffs.”
“Nope.” Catra waves down the waitress, “Grab another one of those drinks please.”
“You going to pay, darl?” The waitress asks with a hand on her hip, “You still owe me for spotting you the last time you were here.”
“I thought I already paid that debt off…” Catra drawls with a mischievous grin, “I lost count how many times you nearly crushed my head…”
The waitress quirks an eyebrow at the magicat, “You think a couple of orgasms is enough to pay off your tab?”
“A couple?” Catra acts aghast, “If I remember… you passed out after…”
“Okay!” Adora interrupts, “I really don’t need to hear any of this.” She turns to the waitress, “Don’t serve her anymore drinks. Cut her off now.”
The waitress looks Adora up and down, measuring her up before speaking, “And who are you, blondie?”
“Blondie?” Adora repeats a little miffed, “I’m so sick of being called that!”
“I wouldn’t piss off princess if I were you.” Catra warns with a drunken grin on her face towards the waitress, “Trust me. She’ll throw you in a weird ass prison and not feed you.”
“Hey! That was one time! And I didn’t know you didn’t get fed!” Adora huffs out as Catra cackles.
“Whatever.” The waitress groans, before looking at Catra, “Pay your tab.”
Catra grins back at her, wiggling her eyebrows suggestively.
“No. I’m not paying it for you again.” The waitress tells the magicat, “Plus I’m off the market now. So, I’m not sleeping with you again.”
“Oh.” Catra mouths the word, “Uh… congrats…?”
“Damn right, congrats.” The waitress says with a smile, “You

better not skip out on that tab."
"I won't." Catra nods before nudging Adora, "How much you got?"
"What?!" Adora turns her head in disbelief, "You're kidding me, right?"
Catra shakes her head, turning to Stone and then back to Adora, "Well, Stone's got zero dollars. And I've got…" the magicat digs through her pockets and pulls out some bits and bobs, "Aha! I have… $3.25."
"I'll take that." The waitress snatches the money out of Catra's hand, "Where's the rest?"
Adora sighs and reaches into her pockets and pulls out a few notes which the waitress promptly snatches out of her hand too, "Hey!"
The waitress counts the money and smiles back at them sated, "Just enough. Thank you."
"Uh, yeah." Adora waves her off before glaring at Catra.
"And you." The waitress jabs the magicat in the chest, "If it doesn't work out between me and…"
"Ahem!" Adora clears her throat loudly and a little angrily at that.
"Chill out, Adora." Catra laughs, "I'm sure Mabel and her… lover… will be together, forever. Happily ever after and all that shit."
"You think so?" The waitress, Mabel, says genuinely, "Thank you! I wasn't sure at the start, but I think you're right. It will work out and we will be together forever."
"Congrats again, Mabel." Catra repeats, "Invite me to the wedding *only* if you've got an open bar."
The waitress rolls her eyes at the magicat, "I have to get back to work now." She leans in and presses a soft kiss on Catra's cheek, "That's the last kiss you'll get from me."
"Sure." Catra grins again, touching her cheek where Mabel had just kissed her, "Remember! Open bar only!"
Mabel laughs and walks away, collecting a few empty glasses and bottles as she disappears back behind the bar.

"Oops." Catra says still swaying a little from the drink, "Stone's getting away."
"What? How?" Adora stares at the empty cuff attached to Catra's wrist, "Where did they go?"

“Probably turned into a bug or something.” Catra shrugs, making no attempt to find them.
Adora huffs out again, “Aren’t you going to go get them?!”
“Nah, I’m in a pretty good spot.” Catra shuts her eyes and sways a little more before opening them again and seeing Adora look angry, before groaning out, “Ugh! Fine. This is your fault by the way.”
“It is not!” Adora protests, “You let them go!”
Catra holds up the empty cuff still connected to her, “How exactly did I do that?”
“You… you just did!” Adora crosses her arms over her chest.
“Don’t get your panties in a twist, princess.” Catra licks her lips, tasting the last of her drink, “Stone’s not going to get anyone tonight, turning into something that small apparently means it’ll take them a shit load more energy to turn back. They’ll be exhausted when they do get back into normal people form. You can relax. Take a load off. How about you buy us some drinks?”
“That waitress took all my money.” Adora huffs out, still glaring at the magicat, “And I haven’t even got a place to stay tonight.”
“Stay with me.” Catra simply says, “I’ve got a room.”
“I’m not sleeping with you.” Adora says with a slight frown.
“Uh… I didn’t ask you to.” Catra raises an eyebrow at the forwardness of the blonde, “I just meant, I’ve got a room. You can just stay with me. I never said you would have to sleep with me.”
“I know what you’re up to.” Adora narrows her eyes at the magicat.
Catra puts her hands up, “Whatever. Stay, don’t stay. I don’t care.” She unlocks the cuff from her wrist and puts it back into her pocket, “I’ve got to go see a woman about an enchantment tonight anyways.”
“You’re going to see a witch?” Adora asks.
“Didn’t say that.” Catra shrugs, “Anyways, I’m in room 4 at the Purple Giant. Knock if you need a place to stay tonight. Until then.” Catra does a mock bow and then walks out of the tavern, happily tipsy as she grabs another drink on the way out from a cute woman’s hand, leaning in and whispering something into her ear before walking out the door.

KNOCK KNOCK

“Ugh… my head.” Catra groans as she grabs the second pillow and uses it to muffle the sound of knocking.

KNOCK KNOCK

“Fuck…” Catra groans again, slamming the pillow back on the bed as the knocking continues as she gets out of bed and stomps to the door, pulling it open to growl at whoever has woken her up from her slumber before she looks at who it is, surprised, “Oh. It’s you.”
“Hi.” Adora greets back looking sheepish.
Too tired to tease, the magicat just steps aside and Adora walks in, “You’ve got 2 sleeping options, princess. Bed or floor.”
“Where are you sleeping?” Adora asks shyly.
“Bed.”
“I’ll take the floor.” Adora quickly says as she looks around and then grimaces when she looks at the floor, “Uh…”
“Bed?” Catra asks, “The floor is kind of… gross.”
Adora looks at the unmade bed, “You sleep in the middle?”
“When I’m alone I do.” Catra trudges back over to the bed and makes it up so that the two pillows are now side by side and not one in the middle and the other slammed somewhere in the middle of the bed, “I usually take the right. You can take the left.”
Catra yawns as she gets back into bed, Adora makes her way over and stands at the foot of it, “You’re not going to try something… are you?”
“Fuck off, Adora.” Catra grumbles, “I’m not a creep. And if I wanted to get laid tonight, I would have gone back to that cute woman back at the tavern that spotted me a beer or three tonight.”
Adora huffs out, not moving, “You promise?”
“Yes.” Catra groans out, “What are you doing here so late anyways?”
“No one would give me a room for free.” Adora admits a little annoyed.

“Should have used your She-Ra cred, dumbass.” Catra mumbles as she gets comfortable under the blankets, “Turn off the light when you stop being an idiot.”
“Hey!” Adora whines, “I am *not* an idiot.”
“Whatever. Turn off the light and get your ass in here.” Catra mumbles again, “I’ve got a headache.”
Adora sighs, walking over to turn off the light and then slowly gets out of her day clothes and slips in under the blankets, turning over so she’s got her back to Catra, “Thank you for letting me stay here with you.”
“M’kay.” Catra breathes out as she starts to fall back asleep.
Adora shuts her eyes and soon enough, the sound of Catra’s purrs help her fall asleep.

“Hey, Adora.” Catra pokes the blonde’s cheek softy, “Adora. Hey. Wake up, princess.”
“Quit poking me!” Adora slaps Catra’s hand away as she opens her eyes slowly to the sight of the magicat staring at her with a smirk, she’s standing next to where Adora is sleeping, “Why are you poking me?”
“Check out time, princess.” Catra grins, teeth and all.
“What time is it?” The blonde sits up and Catra’s eyes widen, the magicat turning around quickly, “What are… oh.” Adora quickly pulls the blankets back up, the straps of her bra fallen off her shoulders as she pushes them back into place with a slight blush on her face.
“I didn’t see anything.” Catra says.
“Uh huh.” Adora rubs her face, “Nothing to see anyway.”
Catra doesn’t reply to that, instead there’s a strange growling noise coming from the magicat.
“Pass me my clothes please?” Adora asks as she holds the blankets tight around herself, “You can look. I’m covered up now.”
“Thank the stars…” Catra says under her breath as she grabs the blonde’s clothes and puts them on the bed, “Uh… I’ll wait for you downstairs. Just shut the door behind you.”
“Okay.” Adora nods as Catra doesn’t look back, she watches the

magicat exit the room before she finally gets dressed and ready for the day.

"Alright, Adora." Catra gets up after finishing her breakfast, "I've got to go now. Until next time… I guess."
"Where are you going now?" Adora asks as she wipes her mouth with the back of her hand, "Shouldn't we be looking for Stone?"
"No point." Catra shrugs, "Stone's destroyed my gem. So, I'm going to see my woman again about that enchantment."
"Your… woman?"
"My contact." Catra elaborates and Adora nods a little in relief, "She's definitely not my woman. I don't got one of them."
"What are you getting enchanted?" Adora asks ignoring Catra's answer, as she gets up to follow the magicat out.
"My cuffs." Catra replies before she frowns over at Adora, "Why are you following me again? Did I not make myself clear yesterday?"
"Yes." Adora replies before adding, "But I don't care."
"Really, Adora?" Catra grunts out, "I did you a favour last night. The least you can do is to leave me alone."
"Again, no." Adora smirks back, "Besides I know you liked me sleeping next to you last night..."
"Go find Stone." Catra tells the blonde, ignoring the smug look on Adora's face, "Isn't that what you're supposed to do?"
"I'm not going to find them. I have no idea what they look like or where they're going to be." Adora admits with a groan of defeat.
"So… the mighty She-Ra can't find a shapeshifter…" Catra starts to taunt before the pout on Adora's face has her reeling, "How were you planning to hold them after you arrested them anyway?"
"No idea." Adora admits again with another groan, "I guess once I got them back to Bright Moon, Glimmer would use a spell to keep them under arrest."
"Uh huh…" Catra replies with a raised eyebrow, "Good plan…"
"Shut up!" Adora shoves Catra, but there's a little smile on her face, "Let me come with you."
"You want to… *come* with me?" Catra grins as Adora's face turns red, the magicat cackling at the response, "Stars… you're easy to

rile up!”
“Shut up!” Adora shoves Catra again, her face still beet red.
“Okay.” Catra smiles back and starts to walk away.
Adora turns and quickly follows after the magicat, “Hey! Wait up!”

“Catra!” Entrapta rushes over and pulls the magicat in for a hug, “You’re back! And so soon!”
“Hey, Traps.” Catra pats the woman on the shoulder, “I told you I would be back today.”
“Did you bring it?!” Entrapta bounces around excitedly, “Did you? Did you?!”
Catra laughs, “Calm down, Traps.”
“I am calm!” The purple haired woman beams at her, “I’ve had to drink a few energy drinks to get to this calm again.”
“Okay.” Catra pulls the gem out from her pocket and throws it to the woman, “Here. It’s broken like I said it was.”
“Ooh!” Entrapta holds the blue gem up towards the light, “Stone broke the… stone?”
The ensuing cackle from Entrapta has Catra smiling from ear to ear, “Love it.”
“I know.” Entrapta continues to beam at Catra, “That’s because I love you too!”
“What is going on here?” Adora mumbles to herself.
“Oh, hello Adora!” Entrapta waves to the blonde despite Adora being less than a metre away, “What are you doing here?”
“How do you know Catra?” Adora asks with a quirk of an eyebrow as the purple haired woman pulls the magicat into her side, the sight doesn’t make anything clearer to Adora.
“Entrapta’s a friend.” Catra shrugs.
“I love Catra!” Entrapta shouts out happily and Adora’s jaw just drops a little.
Catra laughs, “Love is a strong word, Traps…”
“I know!” Entrapta laughs as well, “But I also know your mannerisms so I know you love me back even if you can’t verbalise it!”
“…what?” Adora tilts her head in confusion.
“Oh, it’s all in way Catra’s body reacts to certain things.” Entrapta

starts to explain, “Like the way her tail will sway lazily when she’s happy or when she starts to purr when she’s comfortable.”
Catra quickly puts a hand over her friend’s mouth, “Traps. Remember we spoke about you not telling strangers about my… tells…?”
“Oh…” Entrapta looks between the magicat and the blonde before she smiles back at Catra, “Adora’s not a stranger!”
Catra groans.
“Yeah, Catra. I’m not a stranger.” Adora teases, “Tell me more, Entrapta.”
“Nope!” Catra pulls the purple haired woman back again, “Concentrate. I need these enchanted or whatever you do.” The magicat tosses her the handcuffs and Entrapta turns a slight shade of pink as Catra just looks at her, “Why are you acting weirder all of a sudden?”
Entrapta just grins sheepishly, “You used these on me…”
“Oh.”
“In bed.” Entrapta adds, not that anyone was asking, “And then we…”
“Nope!” Catra cuts her off again, “Reminisce when we don’t have Adora here.”
Entrapta frowns down for a moment before she realises something, her smile growing wider as she looks between Adora and Catra, “Okay. I’ll think about that time you and me had…”
“Entrapta.” Adora cuts her off this time, shaking her head and trying not to grit her teeth, it feels like jealousy churning in her stomach as she decides to change the subject, “Do you know how we can contain Stone, the shapeshifter?”
“Yes!” the purple haired woman replies happily before she looks at Adora, “Are you and Catra sleeping together?”
“No.” Catra says.
“Yes.” Adora says at the same time, “Just next to each other.”
“No.” Catra repeats again a little louder, “We aren’t sleeping together. I’m just after my bounty. Stone’s *my* bounty.”
“You’re just in this for the money, Catra.” Adora scoffs out, “You don’t care that they’re out there killing people!”
“Yes, she does.” Entrapta pipes up, looking at Adora she asks, “Do you know what the bounty on Stone is?”

“No.” Adora replies.
“Oh… that makes sense.” Entrapta nods and Catra takes a few steps back to lean back against a wall.
“What is the bounty?” Adora asks.
“It’s worth different things to different hunters.” Entrapta explains.
Adora turns to Catra, “What’s the bounty worth to you?”
Catra raises her eyebrows at the blonde, her tails flicks around not sure if she wants to answer or not as Entrapta moves over to a different table with the cuffs.
“Well?” Adora asks again, “How much?”
Catra bores her eyes into Adora’s and then says, “What’s the price of freedom?”

Chapter End Notes

Hm... what? Another twist?
Of course! Like you guys weren't expecting that, right?

Thanks for reading, kudos and comments!

I love writing Entrapta and Catra interactions - just putting that out there.

Naps

Chapter Summary

Freedom? From who or what?!

Chapter Notes

New chapter! Enjoy!

CW: Talk of non-consent/dubious consent...?

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora stares back at the magicat, narrowing her eyes, "Are you a prisoner? A slave?"
Catra stares right back at the blonde, a look of bewilderment on her face as she realises how her previous statement must have sounded like, "Uh… what?"
"You said the bounty for Stone was your freedom." Adora reiterates, "What are you trying to get free from?"
"Oh…" Catra's eyes widen, "No. That's… that's not what I meant."
"Then, what did you mean?" Adora huffs, crossing her arms over her chest, "If you are neither a prisoner nor a slave, then what are you if you aren't free?"
"I'm a bounty hunter slash freedom fighter." Catra replies with a sly grin, "It's not my freedom I'm getting as my reward for bringing in that piece of shit, Stone."
"Catra! Just tell me! Stop dragging this out." Adora groans, "Why can't you just give me a straight answer?!"
"Straight…" Entrapta snorts from behind the pair, Adora turns to her with an irritated look on her face as the purple haired woman just waves her arms around, "Sorry! Catra is *so* not straight. I should know."
"Traps…" Catra breathes out with a shake of her head and a small grin on her face, "Adora doesn't need to know about that…"
"That?" Entrapta laughs, "*That* didn't even happen! Not after I mentioned bringing a third party into our fun…"

“Yeah. Because you wanted to bring your boyfriend into it.” Catra grunts out with another shake of her head.
“Lab partner!” Entrapta corrects, “I guess I should have trusted my data… you definitely were not into having him join…”
“No. I would rather not share my women.” Catra rolls her eyes, “But… where was I?”
“Your bounty?” Adora brings up again, the annoyance rolling off her, “Your freedom?”
“Not my freedom.” Catra says before looking back at Entrapta, “Our friend is being held by a corrupt tyrant. To get her out, I need to bring Stone back *alive* in exchange for our friend.”
“You really expect me to believe that?” Adora huffs again not believing Catra’s explanation, “There are no tyrants around holding people hostage. Not anymore.”
“Yes, there are.” Entrapta pipes up, “Oh… that’s right. You don’t hear about anything that’s not Bright Moon related…”
“What do you mean?” Adora asks with a frown, “There isn’t! We got rid of all of them.”
“Ha! You’ll never get rid of all the scum.” Catra replies with a scoff, “As much as you’d like to think you have, you haven’t. You take one out, another just takes their place.”
“No. You’re wrong.” The blonde vehemently denies, “Glimmer said so.”
“Yeah, and I’m sure *Glimmer* knows all.” Catra shakes her head, “So, anyway. My bounty is our friend’s freedom and at the same time, Stone will get his comeuppance. That tyrant as you like to call them, really doesn’t like them.”
“Where are you taking them?” Adora asks.
“Back to the fucking Zone.” Catra answers, “What happens to them there, is not my problem. As long as we get our friend back, I really couldn’t give two fucks.”
“How do you know that they’ll make the exchange? That they won’t keep using you for more *bounties?”* Adora narrows her eyes at Catra, “Because if you’re so good at what you apparently do, what would stop them from doing that?”
Catra shrugs as the realisation hits that Adora may be right. And stars… does she hate thinking that Adora could be right. The magicat grunts, “Well, what else am I supposed to do, princess?”

“Let me help.” Adora offers up, “Stone needs to pay for what they’ve done.”
“No. You aren’t taking them to Bright Moon’s sparkly queen.” Catra rolls her eyes, “I’ve got less than a week to bring that dirtbag back to the Zone before that tyrant kills my friend.” She turns to Entrapta, “Which is why I need Traps to get those cuffs to work on keeping that jerk, caught.”
“I’m working on it!” Entrapta shouts out from where she’s working, “I just need a day at the most!”
“Well, right.” Catra nods, she grabs Adora’s hand and the blonde jolts slightly at the movement, “Come on. I’m starving.”
“You’re always hungry.” Adora says as she lets Catra drag her out of Entrapta’s lab, “Where are we going?”
“What can I say? I’m going to enjoy having regular meals while I can.” Catra simply replies, tugging Adora outside and toward town, “Good thing Stone isn’t going to pop back up into their bigger form for a little while longer. I really don’t want to deal with that ass right now. Especially if I can’t keep them arrested.”
“Well… I guess I should get something to eat…” Adora reluctantly agrees.

“So…” Adora starts as she watches Catra stuff her face with more meat, “This, friend of yours…”
“Yeah?” Catra says after clearing her mouthful before pointing to Adora’s plate, “Are you going to eat that?”
Adora frowns and covers her plate with her hands protectively, “Yes.”
“Oh, yeah.” Catra looks around longingly for something else to consume before Adora finally sighs and moves her plate in front of the magicat, “Thanks!”
“Unbelievable…” Adora mutters under her breath, “Anyway… about this friend of yours that you are trading for Stone…”
“What about her?”
“Who is she?” Adora picks up her drink and takes a sip.
Catra swallows down her mouthful, wiping her mouth with the back of her hand before replying, “She’s a friend. A good friend.”
“Okay… who is this… tyrant? And why don’t I know about them?”

Adora puts her drink down and drums her fingers on the table, "I should know these things. I'm She-Ra after all."
"You're She-Ra. So what?" Catra replies licking her teeth, "You're not psychic or a god, princess."
"But I'm supposed to be this legendary warrior." Adora groans out as she flops down on the table, head on her arms, "I'm supposed to bring peace to the world."
"And for the most part, you have." Catra says, "Don't beat yourself up, dude."
Adora's head tilts up, "Did you just call me dude?"
"Yeah, dude." Catra repeats with a grin.
"You can't call me dude. Dude." Adora grunts out but there's a little smile on her lips, knowing that Catra is trying to make her feel a little bit better, "I'm a fucking princess. She-Ra, princess of power, or whatever."
Catra chuckles, "And you call me ridiculous."
"That's because you are, *dude."* Adora throws back, sticking her tongue out childishly, "Who is this tyrant that I have to dispatch?"
"Well, if you must know." Catra sits up a little straighter, "After the war, a real prick of a guy took power after you and the princesses dispatched Prime and whatever."
"Uh huh…" Adora gestures for the magicat to continue.
"Have you heard of Griff?" Catra asks and Adora shakes her head, "It's actually pretty funny. The dick made up his own moniker, Griff the Gorgeous. Or to the rest of us, Griff the Gross."
"Griff?" Adora says the name, "Never heard of him. Why does he want Stone?"
"Stone wrecked his face." Catra shrugs, "It's like a scratch under his chin. Barely noticeable. Griff is an idiot."
"Okay… but how did your friend get caught up in this?" Adora asks.
"She got caught in the middle of a fight." Catra sighs, "The idiot thought she was helping the little guy. But she was inadvertently helping Stone in shapeshifter form of her girlfriend. And when she turned around and found that it was Stone and not her girlfriend… well, everything kind of went to shit."
"Uh…"
"Griff the Gross, accused her of helping Stone escape, which in all

honesty… she kind of did.” Catra scratches her head, just behind her ear, “But! It’s not like she knew it was Stone. She thought she was helping Perfuma!”
“Wait! Perfuma? I know Perfuma!” Adora pipes up, “Actually, can we go back to the fact that your friend is Perfuma’s girlfriend?”
“Didn’t realise it was a secret.” Catra shrugs again, “Anyways, Griff the Gross basically sentenced her to death for helping Stone escape. In which I then stepped up.” Catra stands up from her seat, her hand over her heart, “And then I suggested an alternative.”
“You trade Stone for your friend’s life.” Adora surmises.
Catra nods.
“How long did this… Griff guy give you?” Adora asks.
“A month.” Catra replies, “The sneaky little shit is not the easiest to track.”
“I know. I’ve had to follow you to find them.” Adora admits with a huff before realising she said that out loud and then grumbles at Catra’s preening, “Sit down, dude. I’m not complimenting you.”
“Sure sounds like it.” Catra says smugly as she’s tugged back down into her seat with a laugh, “Well, what do you want to do now?”
“Honestly? I could go for a nap.” Adora yawns to prove her point.
“Just say you want to sleep with me, princess.” Catra smirks and Adora shoves her off her seat playfully, the magicat laughing it off, “Hey! You have to be nice to me or I won’t sleep with you.”
“I don’t need you to sleep with me.” Adora rolls her eyes, “I’ll just get a room myself with my own bed and everything.”
“In this town?” Catra quirks her eyebrow at the blonde, “Good luck, Adora. Let me know how you go.”
Catra clambers back onto her chair as Adora narrows her eyes at the magicat, “What are you planning to do then?”
“Get drunk, probably.” Catra replies looking around at the bar, “Can I get you one too?”
“No, thank you.” Adora holds her hand up, “And I don’t think you should either.”
“Why not?”
“You can’t be on your game if you’re drunk.” Adora points out before quickly adding, “To catch Stone. That’s all.”

“Uh… what game are you even talking about?” Catra scrunches her face up, “If Stone shows up in his bigger form again, I’ll know. That shithead has a scent like rotting meat that’s hard to miss.”
“Gross.”
“Tell me about it.” Catra laughs, “You’re lucky your human nose can’t sniff that crap.”
“First one.” Adora corrects, “Not a human. I’m a First One.”
“First one of what?” Catra asks, “I don’t understand.”
“It’s a race.”
“Race to what?”
“Oh my stars! Catra! Stop it!” Adora breathes out but there’s another smile on her lips, “I’m going to go find a place to nap.”
“You’re not going to find one.” Catra warns.
“Then get me a room, please, dude.” Adora sighs out, “Surely you’ve got a way to get a place to crash.”
“I do.” Catra nods, before standing up again, “Come on. I’ve got to see a woman about a bed.”
“You are so terrible.” Adora groans, but once again lets herself be tugged along by the magicat.

“Sweet sleepers, princess.” Catra says as she moves towards the door to leave, “I’ll be at the bar downstairs.”
“Catra! No.” Adora sits up from the bed, “You need to rest too.”
“I’ve literally done very little today.” Catra replies, “Barely even made my steps.”
“Well, you’re not going to get them downstairs getting drunk.” Adora points out.
“Hm… that’s true.” Catra thinks to herself and then looks around the room, “Fuck. There’s only one bed again.”
“Now, who’s being weird?” Adora jests and Catra just rolls her eyes ta the blonde, “Just get in bed, dude.”
“Keep calling me dude, princess and I’ll show you what this *dude* can really do.” Catra threatens as Adora just rolls her eyes at the magicat, “Ugh, fine. But you’re on my side.”
“I am not.” Adora turns over to face the wall, “Quit complaining. I’m too tired to argue with you.”
“Well… if you’re not going move…” Catra pounces and Adora

squeals.
"Catra! Get off!" The blonde screeches, "Stars! Get off, Catra! Quit being such a brat!"
"No. This is *my* side!" Catra squeezes in between Adroa and the wall that's her side, "I can't sleep unless I'm on this side!"
"Ugh! You are the worst!" Adora grumbles as she shifts just enough into the middle of the bed, "I'm not moving."
"Don't care." Catra stretches out in the compact space, sighing out victoriously, "My side."
"Well, then you can stay squished there." Adora huffs out, "Get off the blanket."
Catra grumbles, lifting herself up enough so Adora can grab the blanket, "Happy, now?"
'No." Adora scoffs out as she pulls the blanket over them and then turns over facing the other side and the rest of the bed, "You're an ass."
Catra yawns, "It's too bad you like this ass…" and turning over too and out of habit, pulls her bed mate into her front, rubbing her face against Adora's back before purring and promptly falling asleep.
"Catra?" Adora says, feeling very warm in Catra's arms, and when the magicat's only reply is the purr on her back, she tries again, "Catra?"
The magicat makes a sound similar to a grunt, tightening her hold on the blonde as Adora eventually gives up and gives into being the little spoon.
The pair fall asleep in no time at all.

"Adora." Catra whispers, gently shaking the blonde, "Adora. Wake up."
"Hm? What?" Adora stirs in the darkness, "Catra?"
"Shh…" Catra puts her hand gently over Adora's mouth, "Someone's trying to get in…"
Adora frowns, pulling Catra's hand off her mouth, "So? We can take whoever it is."
"We can't…" Catra whispers back harshly, "This isn't… we need to get out… quietly…"

"Why?"
"Because we can't attack the owner of the room…" Catra replies sheepishly, "Wouldn't be a good look."
"Stars… are you fucking serious, Catra?" Adora chastises the magicat in an angry whisper, "Who… who the hell's place is this?"
"Uh… and ex of an ex or something…?" Catra replies with a wry grin, "Pretty sure they're still pissed at me because I kind of… got really drunk and threw up on their shoes and then tried to make out with her after…"
Adora frowns, "That's… that's super gross."
"It was a long time ago…" Catra defends, "And I'll explain everything after. We just need to go. Like now. And you can't go cracking heads."
"Why can't we just leave through the door?" Adora asks incredulously.
"Uh… pretty sure that woman I spoke to, to get this room had it in for me… I'm not sure why though…" Catra looks around in room for an answer and finding none, "Anyways, come on. If she sees me leaving with you, she'll probably kill me and you. Princess or not."
And before Adora can respond, Catra's tugged her up and out of bed and towards the window, "I'm not climbing out a window!" Adora whisper shouts.
"Climb on my back, I'll carry you down." Catra doesn't bother waiting for Adora to make a decision, grabbing the blonde and throwing her onto her back before climbing out the window earning herself a yelp from the blonde as she quickly gets to the ground and lowers Adora back down to her feet, "We should get back to Entratpa's."
"Okay."

"You're back! I'm still not done yet." Entrapta tells them as she continues to work on the cuffs, "I'm in the final stages though."
"That's great, Traps." Catra says as she steps inside in front of Adora, "What can we do to make it go faster?"
"You can test this for me." Entrapta holds up the cuffs, "It's the testing phase. I just need someone to test it on since I can't do it

on myself."
"Great. Use Adora." Catra suggests, "I prefer to watch the testing phases anyways."
"Woah, no. No way!" Adora quickly protests, "You are not putting those cuffs on me."
"Why not?" Catra tilts her head at the blonde, "If anyone should be testing it out of the three of us, I think you would be the obvious choice."
"Why? Why me?"
"Because you're like, She-Ra, magical princess or whatever." Catra says matter of factly, "And I got no magic apart from the name of my species being completely misleading."
"So, what if I am a princess?" Adora argues, "What does that matter?"
"Well, it would test the cuffs strength or whatever against magic." Catra says.
"But shapeshifters aren't magic. What is this going to prove exactly?" Adora points out, "Why would it matter if She-Ra could or couldn't get out of the cuffs?"
"I'd be interested!" Entrapta shouts out, throwing the cuffs at Catra, "Plus I think Catra would be equally interested. Though I suspect for other matters. Probably something to do with sex."
Catra clears her throat loudly, "Traps…"
"No. Definitely not." Adora says before turning to Catra, "Also, no. I'm not into… that."
"Have you ever tried it, princess? How do you know it's not a kink you might like?" Catra jests as Adora flushes red before letting the blonde off the hook, "You know what, I'll get DT. They're a shapeshifter. I just need to…"
"Aren't they still pissed off at you?" Entrapta helpfully provides, "Something about lack of payment?"
"Uh… not exactly." Catra rubs the back of her neck angrily, "They're pissed at me because I refused to sleep with them..."
"Haven't you already slept with them?" Entrapta asks curiosity in her tone with a little amusement mixed in, "I thought you guys were all good on that front."
"The fucker tricked me the first time." Catra growls out, "Pretended to be someone else and when we were basking in the

afterglow, transformed back into their shapeshifting self."
"Why are you still friends with them, again?" Entrapta asks.
"That's wrong. Even I know that." Adora butts in this time, a frown on her face at hearing that fact, "Like all levels of wrong."
"I know." Catra sighs out, "But, they are the only other shapeshifter I know."
"Oh."
"Unless you know someone from your princess-y dealings?" Catra asks a little hopeful, "Do you?" Adora shakes her head, "Okay, well, then I guess DT it is."
"Uh… how do you plan to get them here?" Entrapta asks, "You guys weren't on the best of terms… by the sounds of what you just said…"
"They'll come if I ask them to. For a price of course." Catra groans out, "The *price* is always a variable. But… yeah, I'll ask."
Catra pulls out her phone and starts to dial, turning around to get some privacy as Entrapta sidles up to Adora, nudging her slightly and then stage whispering, "Don't worry, Catra doesn't like DT in that way. Never has. She thought she was sleeping with a cute blonde that kind of looked like you."
Adora turns on her heel to face Entrapta, a blush on her face, "Why are you telling me this?"
"No reason." Entrapta replies, with definitely a reason, "Just thought you wanted to know. Our magicat definitely has a type. And you fit it quite nicely. Just one thing though…"
"I'm afraid to ask." Adora sighs out.
"Don't… don't hurt her." Entrapta says as they watch Catra pace back and forth, "She likes you. A lot. And… it's been a while since she's like anyone enough to bring them to meet me."
"Isn't that because Stone…" Adora starts.
"No. She's never brought anyone to see me. Ever. And we've had a lot of death defying situations… most of which happen to involve our friend's life." Entrapta explains, "So, if you do not feel the same or don't think you will. You need to tell her right now. Before she gets too involved."
"Uh…"
"Just so you know, napping for magicats isn't a something they generally share with others." Entrapta adds, "And from my data

and resources, she napped with you today.”
“We didn’t sleep together.” Adora quickly says.
“If you mean intercourse, of course not.” Entrapta chuckles, “She likes you. So, sleeping with you just for the sake of sleeping with you is not an option for her.”
“I don’t understand.”
“Her species is quite interesting.” Entrapta says, “Magicats…”
“Traps!” Catra storms over, shoving the phone back in her pocket, “That’s private. Remember?”
“Oh, right.” Entrapta drags the second word out before giving Catra a sheepish smile, “Sorry. So, DT?”
“They’re coming.” Catra replies, “I’m meeting them at the tavern at the edge of the town.”
“I love the Mighty Duckling!” Entratpa beams, “Can I come too? They’re the only place does tiny foods!”
“Uh, do whatever you want.” Catra shrugs.
“I’m coming too.” Adora says as she straightens up, “I don’t like the sound of this DT person.”
“Whatever you want, princess.” Catra replies, “They said they’ll be there in 2 hours or so. I’m going there now. Grab your stuff and we can get going.”

“Ah, darling!” DT bursts in, arms wide and expecting a hug, “What? No hug? And here I thought we were passed all that.”
“You tricked me into sleeping with you.” Catra points out, “That was a dick move.”
“I admit, that wasn’t the best move on my part.” DT says with their hand on their chest, “But I was horny and you were too. So, two birds, one stone, if you ask me.”
“No one asked you.” Catra growls before ripping DTs hand from their chest and slapping the cuff over their wrist, the other side of the cuff onto her own wrist.
“Ooh, kinky!” DT lights up, “And here I thought you were mad at me.”
“I am mad at you.” Catra growls out, “We aren’t fucking since I know it’s you.”
“Ouch.” DT feigns hurt, “Then what’s with this?”

“It’s a test. You owe me that much.” Catra says, “Shapeshift out.”
“Honey, that’s not going to happen.” DT shakes their head, “Not without a price.”
Catra grabs DT by the shirt harshly so they are face to face, “You tricked me into something I did not consent to. And if you don’t want me to rip you to shreds, do what I fucking say. That’s the price today. Now. Shapeshift.”
The magicat narrows her eyes into DT’s for a moment longer before releasing her grip on them, the shapeshifter sighs dramatically, “You can’t say that we didn’t have fun.”
Catra glares at them in response.
“Fine! Fine.” DT concedes before looking around the room and spotting Adora, “Tell you what, I’ll transform into that blonde over there and then I can make it up to you in a little… fun.”
“Whatever.” Catra shakes her head, “Shapeshift already.”
DT rolls their eyes, “Okay, let me just…” the shapeshifter closes their eyes and takes a few deep breaths in and out, “Here we go…”
Catra impatiently waits as DT draws it out, “Come on! It doesn’t take this long!”
“Hey! I’m trying!” DT groans back at the magicat, “Something’s wrong…” they look down at the cuff around their wrist, “Oh. That is low!”
“Nothing is too low for me.” Catra smirks, “Actually, I have a better idea to test this theory.”
“What? You don’t believe me?” DT huffs out.
“Not a chance.” Catra replies, pulling them along with her towards a different part of the tavern, “Care to say hello to a few friends of yours?”
“Wait! No!” DT struggles against the magicat’s pull, the shapeshifter trying to shift into a form to get out of the cuffs and failing, “Okay! Okay, you’ve proven your point!”
Catra grins as she quickly turns back around, heading back to the main room and uncuffing DT, “Great. Now, you can fuck right off.”
DT glares at them before huffing out, “Whatever. You were a lousy lover anyways.”
“Sure. Like I care what a bottom like you thinks.” Catra replies before waving them off, “Get the fuck out of here before I call

your friends over. I'm sure they're waiting for their *payment."* The magicat bares her teeth, "And I'm guessing from your reaction, that you don't have anything to give." The magicat looks back over towards the other room, "Or am I wrong?"
"This makes us even." DT jabs the magicat in the chest, "You're out of favours. Next time you need something, I'm charging you double."
"Whatever." Catra replies, "You fuck me over. I fuck you over. Now, get the fuck out."
DT scoffs indignantly before storming out of the tavern.
Entrapta comes bounding back, her cheeks stuffed to the brim with tiny food as she tries to smile at Catra, a muffled, "Did it work?" comes out.
Catra chuckles at the site of Entrapta looking like a chipmunk, reaching out to squish her face, "Yeah, it worked. Good work, Traps."
"Did it work?" Adora comes up right behind and looks at Entrapta smiling at her with her face puffed out, "Uh, are you okay? I think your face is a little swollen…?"
Catra laughs, poking Entrapta's face again, "I think the tavern is going to shut soon. We should probably go back to your lab."
"Okay!" Entrapta beams once she's swallowed her face full of food, "I've haven't touched your room since the last time you stayed with me!"
"Great. Let's go." Catra stretches out her arms over her head before remember Adora is still with them, "Oh, uh… are you planning to find a place to stay tonight?"
Adora bites her bottom lip, "You're going to make me ask, aren't you?"
Catra grins knowingly, "Of course I am, princess."
"Ugh." Adora groans out, turning to Entrapta to make a point, "Can I stay with you as well, Entrapta?"
"Yes! But I don't have another bed though…" Entrapta thinks to herself, "But you can ask Catra to sleep in hers. With her."
"Can't I sleep in your bed?" Adora asks instead.
"No. I don't actually have a bed." Entrapta answers in thought, "I had a bed at one point but then realised I didn't use it enough and it started to gather dust. So, I turned it into a sitting area of

sorts. Plus I can't sleep on mattresses, not soft ones anyways. I think it's got something to do with the way I sleep."
"Oh." Adora deflates, "Can we just… go? I'll sleep on the floor or whatever, as long as I'm not out in the open without a tent or a sleeping bag."
"Geez, and here I thought you were all outdoorsy." Catra teases as she holds the door open for the other two to exit, "Or is it only when you're prepared?"
Adora shrugs, "Why slum it when there's proper shelter."
"Touche." Catra nods, "Come on, then."
The magicat takes the front and leads them back to Entrapta's lab.

Adora wakes up, wrapped up warmly in Catra's arms, taking a moment to enjoy it before her brain kicks in and she's quickly pulling away.
"Morning, Adora." Catra whispers still half asleep, "You move around a lot when you sleep."
"Uh..."
"Just thought you'd like to know that you sleep fight." Catra yawns, sitting up and rubbing her eyes, "Okay. Time to get stoned. I mean, Stone."
"Catra!" Entrapta bursts into the room, "Wake up! We have a situation!"
"I'm up! I'm up!" Catra groans at the volume of Entrapta's voice, "What? What's the situation?"
"I've caught reports of someone going around on a stabbing spree in town." Entrapta pulls out her tablet and shows the pair, "Get dressed! I think Stone is back! They just haven't quite got their strength back yet!"
"I didn't realise I was *undressed."* Catra looks down, and sure enough, she is definitely still clothed, she sniffs herself and winces, "Guess I don't have time for a shower, huh?"
"No. No time!" Entrapta shouts before running out of the room.
Catra sighs, "Okay, I guess we better get going now."
"We, huh?" Adora smirks tiredly, "What happened to working alone?"

“Well, I like having you around.” Catra replies honestly before realising she just did, “Oh, I didn’t mean it like that…”
“Then what did you mean it like?” Adora smirks at the magicat.
“I uh…” Catra tries to flatten her short mane that she knows is sticking up, “Come on. We have a serial killer to get.”
Adora laughs as she watches Catra nearly trip over the blankets to get out of bed, “You’re such a terrible liar. And an ass.”
“An ass that I know *you* like.” Catra replies as she shakes off the blanket finally and tosses it back onto the bed.
“Yes. I like you.” Adora declares without an once of hesitation, “Even though you are an ass, dude.”
“Ugh, with the *dude* again.” Catra groans with a grin, holding her hand out to Adora, “Come on. Let’s get Stone, together.”

Chapter End Notes

I've upped the chapter count...by 2, I'm hoping to get this done in few chapters...
but, I don't know.
Glad I don't need to worry about deadlines!

Anyways, sorry for the wait, I've been busy as per usual.
So, thank you for your patience.

Also thank you for reading, kudos and commenting.

Catching the Cat

Chapter Summary

Catra and Adora go get Stone.

Chapter Notes

Sorry for the slowness of this chapter.
But... here it is! Enjoy.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora bends down and inspects what looks like blood droplets on the ground as she looks up and sees a trail. She gets back up, wipes her hand on her pants and then turns to Catra, "I think that's blood."
"It is." Catra confirms sniffing the air.
"Oh." Adora says as she thinks that she should have known that, "Do you know where they are?"
Sniffing the air again, Catra points towards a house with a white picket fence and a blue door, "There." She holds Adora back, "Where do you think you're going?"
"To get Stone." Adora replies a little confused at the magicat's hesitation, "Right?"
"Wrong." Catra sniffs the air again, "We can't storm in there."
"Why not?"
"That blood trail." Catra points at it, "They've got hostages."
"How do you know that?" Adora looks at the blood trail again.
"I just can." Catra says, "We need a plan."
"How about I go in the front and you take the back?" Adora suggests, "Divide and conquer, right?"
"Mm…" Catra thinks for a moment, "How are you going to know which one is Stone?"
"They'll probably be the one answering the door if they've got hostages." Adora hypothesizes, "I mean, it would make sense, right?"
"I guess so." Catra shrugs, "But they're going to be unpredictable

if one of us show up at that door."
"What do you mean?" The blonde frowns with a huff, "They've got hostages, we need to move in quick."
"No. See, this is way I'm the brains of this operation." Catra says without giving Adora a second glance knowing the blonde is probably protesting that, "Let me get a better look at what we are dealing with first before you go in all guns a blazing."
"I don't even have a gun." Adora rolls her eyes, "I've got a sword. A magic sword."
"Yeah, I know. I've seen it." Catra looks at said sword, "Put it away, princess. We're in public!"
Adora rolls her eyes again, sheathing the sword and then crossing her arms, "So, brains of the operation. What's the plan?"
"I need you to cause a commotion or a distraction." Catra says, "Something that will be loud and draw lots of people out onto the streets…"
"Like?"
"Take your clothes off." Catra instructs.
"What?! No! I am not taking my clothes off!" Adora shrieks out, "You take *your* clothes off!"
Catra laughs, "I would, but it's not going to cause as much of a commotion as you would."
"Still, no." Adora says with finality, "Next plan."
"Okay. So… no to the whole naked She-Ra thing?" Catra asks one more time.
"No." Adora sternly replies, "Stop that."
"Sorry." Catra apologises, "It wasn't a real plan."
"Then why mention it?"
Catra shrugs, "I guess I don't really talk to women unless if it's to get them into bed."
"Oh. What about your friends?" Adora asks thinking back to Entrapta and the friend she's trying to save, "You haven't slept with them, have you?"
Catra doesn't answer, "So, the real plan." The magicat changes the subject, "I like the She-Ra idea."
"Catra." Adora wraps her fingers around the magicat's wrist, "Have you slept with your friends?"
"Yes. Can we not talk about that, please?" Catra breathes out and

Adora nods, “So, maybe if you turn into She-Ra and… I don’t know… sign some autographs?”
Adora stares at Catra for a moment before bursting out in laughter, she stops when she accidently snorts, hoping the magicat didn’t catch that, she clears her throat and says, “Autographs? Who really wants my signature?”
“Not yours!” Catra argues, “She-Ra’s!”
“Doesn’t matter.” Adora brushes it off, ‘No one is going to want my autograph.”
“You’re a princess, princess.” Catra deadpans “The kids will love it.”
“What kids, exactly?” Adroa quirks an eye.
“Those kids.” Catra points towards the school, “I can create fanfare for you.”
“Uh…”
“Once those kids are losing their minds at meeting the great and powerful, She-Ra. I’ll sneak around the house and check out what’s going on inside.” Catra surmises, “Yeah?”
“Do you have a plan C?” Adora asks a little nervously.
“Not off the top of my head.” Catra replies before snapping her fingers, “I got it! I can literally smoke them out. Set a fire at the…”
“Woah! No fires!” Adora quickly quells that idea, “Let’s just go with She-Ra being… kid friendly.”
“Are you not comfortable with the little versions of people?” Catra tilts her head at Adora.
“I don’t have much experience with working with kids.” Adora fidgets with her fingers, “Glimmer and Bow usually look after that kind of stuff…”
“Uh… okay…” Catra slowly says, “So, no to the kids?”
“Can we not?”
“Yeah, it’s fine, Adora.” Catra nods, “Uh… what else… I’ve got one more idea.”
“Yeah? What is it?” Adora asks and Catra pulls her into a secluded corner to talk.

“I told you I’d catch you.” She-Ra says as she leads Catra through the small town, ropes tying the magicat’s arms behind her back as the blonde parades her around, “You thought you could just getaway. Ha! Not when the legendary She-Ra is on your case. I’m going to bring you back to Bright Moon for punishment.”
“Tone it down, princess.” Catra grumbles just loud enough for Adora to hear.
The blonde grimaces a little before straightening back up again, “Hush you!”
Catra shakes her head, trying to keep a straight and serious face as they walk past the house with the blue door, in the corner of her eye, she sees a slight movement in the curtain and has to suppress the grin at knowing her plan has caught Stone’s attention, that train of though is broken when She-Ra shoves Catra forward a little more harshly than she was expecting, making her stumble and fall, “Oof… what the fuck, She-Ra?!”
“Oh, stars! I’m so sorry…” She-Ra quickly ducks down and helps Catra back up to her feet, before realising she’s breaking character, “I mean… Ha! That’s what you get!”
Catra rolls her eyes at the blonde, before making a run for it, pulling her arms free from the loosely tired rope, “You suck, princess!” The magicat laughs as she sprints off down the road and rounds a corner as She-Ra gives chase.
“Come back here!” She-Ra shouts running straight past the magicat and further away as a few helpful locals follow suit, “Catra! Come back here!”
The magicat sneaks back towards the house with the blue door, hiding in the shadows of the buildings across the road. The curtain moves again just slightly and Catra catches an eye starting out, but not in her direction thankfully.
She-Ra comes running back down the street, her little group of followers grows as they start to knock on all the doors, asking people to come out to look for the escaped magicat. It’s not long before She-Ra gets to the house with the blue door and knocks. After a few tries, the door finally opens, but only just enough for someone to speak through, “Hello?”
“Oh, hi!” She-Ra gives them the biggest smile she can, “I was wondering if you would like to help me or well, us now.” She

chuckles to herself as she looks around at the rest of her helpers knock on other doors, “Anyway, would you like to help us find Catra? She’s the magicat that got away from me.”
“Oh, no thanks.” The occupant replies before trying to shut the door, but She-Ra sticks her foot in it to jam it, “Excuse me. I said no. I don’t want to get involved with any… magicats.”
“Are you sure? You know that they say…?” She-Ra stalls as the occupant frowns back at them in the darkness of the house, “Well, many hands make light work.”
“I said no.” The occupant repeats a little more sternly, “Now, move your foot.”
“Okay.” She-Ra slowly withdraws her foot, and the doors slams shut, “Hmpf, what a grouch!”
“She-Ra!” One of her helpers calls out, “We think we saw Catra run down towards the tavern on the edge of town!”
“Well, what are we waiting for?” She-Ra says enthusiastically, “Let’s get her back!”
The small crowd of helper’s cheer ad rush down towards the tavern, one of them stops, “Are you not coming?”
“I’ll be right there.” She-Ra smiles, “I’ve just got to make a quick call to Queen Glimmer.”
The helper nods and then joins the rest of the group to the edge of town.
Right when She-Ra has just walked out of sight from the blue door, she yelps when she’s pulled aside and against the wall, “Stars! Catra! Did you have to do that?”
“Yes.” Catra says as She-Ra transforms back into Adora and the magicat raises an eyebrow at her, “Why’d you do that?”
“It’s way more comfortable.” Adora replies as she stretches out her limbs and Catra just shakes her head, “So? What did you find?”
“3 hostages.” Catra starts, “Stone is in the form of a man. You saw him.”
“I actually didn’t get a good look at him.” Adora admits thinking back, “He didn’t open the door wide enough for me to see his face. All I got was a pair of yellow eyes.” She shivers, “Creepy.”
“Hey! I’ve got a yellow eye!” Catra points out.
“Yeah, but you’re not evil.” Adora justifies, the magicat sends her

a questioning look as Adora repeats with a lot more conviction, "You're not evil!"
"Okay, okay." Catra laughs, "Back to the hostages. It's a family. 2 dad's and a kid."
"Why does it have to be a family?!" Adora scoffs, "I have a mind of my own to take Stone out myself."
"Yeah, not happening, princess." Catra replies, "Remember the whole saving my friend?" Adora nods but she's still unhappy, "Anyways, once Griff the Gross lets my friend go, what happens to Stone is really none of my concern."
"What is that supposed to mean?" The blonde furrows her brows.
"It means that if you happen to kidnap them… I mean, apprehend them back." Catra quickly corrects herself, "Then that would be none of my business. Heck I might even have a hand in it."
"What about Griff?"
"What about him?"
"Isn't he going to be pissed?" Adora asks like it's obvious.
"So?"
"So? Catra!" Adora groans, "I don't want a bounty on She-Ra."
"You won't." Catra replies with a shrug, "Only a fool would do something so… foolish." Adora is about to say something else when Catra interrupts her, "Look, we can figure that out after we catch the fucker. Okay?"
"Ugh, fine." Adora reluctantly agrees, "Okay, so what do we do now?"
The magicat shrugs again, "I thought you were the brains of the operation…"
"Ha ha." Adora sarcastically laughs, "Shut up. You know you're the stupid brain."
"That… that's the dumbest thing I've ever heard you say." Catra goads, earning herself a shove from the blonde as she chuckles, "Alright, that family actually does help and we're just wasting time…"
"Yeah." Adora nods in agreement, "We need to lure them out somehow."
"Who?"
"Stone."
"Right." Catra says, "How?"

"Ugh!" Adora groans and Catra chuckles again.
"I'm kidding. I have a plan." Catra says with a grin before pointing to her head, "It's all up here."
"That's of no help." Adora groans again, "Share."
"Sure. But first…" Catra looks around, "Call off your wannabe helpers…"
"Uh, how do I do that exactly?" Adora grimaces over that thought, "The only way for them to stop 'helping' is to catch you…"
"Then, let's do that." Catra grins, much to Adora's confusion, "Trust me, princess."

"Hi everyone! Thanks for coming!" She-Ra greets all her helpers, "With your help, we've managed to get Catra back!"
There's cheers and applause as She-Ra pulls a restrained Catra up and hauls her over her head like a trophy, the magicat rolling her eyes at She-Ra's antics.
After putting Catra back down to her feet, She-Ra addresses the helpers again, "Okay, then. So, I'm going to take Catra back to Bright Moon with me and once again, thank you everyone for your help. You can go home now."
The crowd all congratulate each other as well as She-Ra before heading back to their dwellings, a few hanging about to celebrate with a few drinks as She-Ra picks up the magicat again and hauls her outside and once they are out of sight, she puts Catra back down.
"Did it work?" She-Ra asks, transforming back into her smaller self, "Did they buy it?"
"Yeah, I think so." Catra nods, "Also, *manhandling* me? A little over the top, don't you think?"
Adora blushes, "I thought it would sell it better."
"Sure, you did." Catra drawls with a smirk, "If you wanted to touch me that badly…"
"Oh, stars! Catra!" Adora bemoans before glaring at the magicat, "Besides, if I wanted to touch you, I think I prefer sleeping next to you then having to carry you. You're surprisingly heavy."
"Must be because I'm so muscular." Catra replies amused, "You know what they say…"

“What do they say?”
“Muscle is heavier than fat.” Catra answers with a grin, flexing her biceps under her sleeves and then laughing as Adora just rolls her eyes, “You’re just jealous.”
“Ha! I’ve got way more muscles than you.” Adora turns away with a smug look on her face.
“Yeah, in your princess form.” Catra points out, “But in Adora form, I think we’re pretty much on par.” And before Adora can respond, Catra adds, “I’m not really into muscly chicks anyways. But I’m also not into sticks either. You’re kind of perfect.”
“Uh…” Adora has no words.
“Anyway, I’ll get the hostages. You get Stone.” Catra digs out the cuffs and tosses them to Adora, “Here. You’re going to need them.”
Adora catches the cuffs and looks at them, “How do these work exactly?”
“What do you mean? You just cuff them.” Catra replies obviously, “They won’t be able to shapeshift out of them and escape.”
“Where’s the key?”
“Why?”
“You know, just in case.” Adora says looking at the cuffs.
“You’re not cuffing yourself, Adora.” Catra says bewildered.
“I know! But… what if they like… turn the tables or something?” Adora shuffles awkwardly as Catra looks at her confused, “It could happen!”
“Uh… okay.” Catra says slowly, “I’ve got the key. And if Stone somehow manages to get the better of you, which is not going to happen, just shout out and I’ll be there.”
Adora nods and then breathes out, “What’s the plan? How are you planning to get the hostages out?”

KNOCK KNOCK
“Yes?” The voice answers behind the blue door, “Can I help you?”
“Oh, hi. I’m Adora.” Adora introduces herself, despite the fact that Stone already knows her, “I was wondering if Tylo is in. I was supposed to meet him today, but he never showed.”
“No, sorry. You must have the wrong house.” The voice says

behind the door.
“Come on, I know he’s in there.” Adora laughs out, “I told him I would pay for lunch today.”
“You have the wrong house.” The voice repeats, this time a little more angrily, “Please leave. Now.”
“Wait. Who are you?” Adora asks instead knowing full well it’s Stone, “Ray? Is that you?”
“You’ve got the wrong house!” The voice shouts out this time, “Leave.”
“Hey! I know whose house this is!” Adora shouts back, “What have you done with Tylo and Ray?”

“You’ve got the wrong house, lady!” The voice screams out this time, “There’s no one here by those names! Leave now or I’ll call the police!”
“Go ahead and call them!” Adora shouts through the door, “In fact, I’m going to call them too!”
“Wait!” The voice shouts back.
“What?” Adora huffs out, pulling out her phone to dial the police, when the sound of the door unlocking and the hinges squeaking as the door opens slightly. Adora doesn’t step inside, she waits. She knows better than walking into a trap, “Come out here.”
“I apologize for before.” The voice says a lot more calmer now, “Come inside. I’ll make you a hot drink.”
“No, thank you.” Adora says looking through the door, “You come out here.”
“Come on in, Adora.” The voice says hiding behind the door now, the door still open ajar, “We can sit down and you can wait for them inside.”
“Uh…” Adora looks inside and feels dread, “I… I don’t think so.”
“Are you sure? I can make you a hot tea or a coffee.” The voice continues trying to coax the blonde inside, “There’s plenty of room to sit down and relax.”
Adora puts a hand in her pocket, her fingers touching the cuffs at the bottom as she swallows down hard, “Why don’t you come out here?”
“Why won’t you come inside, Adora?” The voice taunts, “What are you so scared of?”

“I’m not scared of anything.” Adora throws back and against her better judgement, pushes the door open harder and steps inside. The door slams shut behind her as Stone pulls out a gun, pointing it at her with a grin in their shapeshifter form of a middle aged man, wearing a grey sweater and brown pants, their eyes remain yellow as they grin at Adora, “Lets not be too hasty…”
“Shut up!” Stone growls out, waving the gun and signalling for Adora to step in further, “Get in the living room. Now!”
“Okay.” Adora holds her hand up, “Just… take it easy…”
“Shut up!” Stone repeats shoving Adora forward, “Get on the floor!”
Adora looks around and sees the living room empty and then looks down at the carpeted floor stained with blood, “Uh… do I have to?”
“Get on the floor!” Stone shouts this time, waving the gun erratically at Adora who takes a step back, “Now!”

WHACK! THUMP!

“Cuffs.” Catra pants out, “Please.”
Adora digs into her pocket and tosses them to the magicat, “Where did you come from?”
“Back door.” Catra replies as she moves Stone’s arms so she can cuff them together, “Are you okay?”
“Yeah.” Adora nods breathing out, “I could have taken them down, you know.”
“I know.” Catra says as she hauls Stone up, the shapeshifter is dead weight as she manoeuvres them up and over her shoulders, “You could have gone all She-Ra on them. I know. But you also couldn’t risk it if I was still in here or the hostages were still in here.”
Adora nods again but this time more in awe that the magicat understood why she hadn’t taken Stone out when he had a gun pointed at her, “Are the hostages okay?”
“Yeah, they’ll be fine.” Catra says, “Actually, you might want to let

them out."
"Where are they?"
"I shoved them down into one of those old fall out shelters they've got in their backyard." Catra grunts a little, shuffling so she doesn't drop Stone, "Fuck me. Stone's as heavy as a… well, as a huge ass boulder."
"What? Not a stone?" Adora giggles out before realising that she should probably go free the hostages, "What about you?"
"What about me?" Catra quirks her eyebrow at the blonde, "You worried about me or something?"
Adora rolls her eyes, but she can't help the sincerity coming out her mouth, "Yes. You worry the crap out of me."
"Oh." Taken aback by Adora's honesty, the magicat softens, "Well, uh, nothing to worry about, princess. I'll meet you back at Trap's lab. She's got a place to hold this fuckwit."
"You better not be leaving town without me." Adora warns.
"Wouldn't dream of it." Catra grins back at the blonde, "Now, I've got to find a way to get back to Trap's lab without being seen while carrying this heavy as fuck piece of shit."
Adora giggles again, "I'll see you there in a little." The blonde thinks for a moment, "Actually, I'll catch you up. I don't think you'll be getting anywhere fast. Not with those skinny little arms of yours."
"Been checking me out, have you?" Catra drawls before laughing, "Anyway, see you either there or on my way there. Don't take too long."
And with that, Catra does a mock salute with her right hand quickly, trying not to drop Stone in the process before heading out.

"Want me to take over?" Adora pants out from behind Catra still making her way back to Entrapta's lab.
"Nah, I'm good." Catra grunts out defiantly, "It's not far from here."
"Also, why didn't you untie them?" Adora asks referring to the family that Stone had taken hostage, "That was a dick move."
Catra laughs, "Please. Don't say dick to me, Adora."

“Ugh! You know what I mean!” Adora pouts as she walks next to Catra, finally catching her breath since the magicat isn’t moving so fast carrying Stone on her shoulders, “You could have at least untied them first.”
“I got them out.” Catra replies a little amused, “It’s not my fault they couldn’t wriggle out of their restraints even though I’d already slit the ties.”
“You’re supposed to tell them, not scare them, Catra.” Adora groans out, “How are you supposed to be a hero if you keep scaring people?”
Catra stops in her tracks as Adora walks ahead a few steps ahead before realising the magicat had stopped, she looks back and Catra averts her gaze to the ground, her brows furrowed in thought, “Did you… did you just refer to me as a hero?”
“…yes?”
“Take it back.” Catra demands, “Don’t call me that.”
Adora smiles back, “No. I don’t think I will.”
Catra starts walking again, “You’re the hero here, remember? I’m just here for my bounty. Just call me the hunter.”
“You’re cute.” Adora blurts out at Catra’s reluctance to getting a compliment, which earns her a small growl, “That’s kind of cute too.”
“Stop calling me cute.” Catra grunts out and picks up her pace to walk ahead of Adora who just giggles as she easily catches up.
“What’s wrong, Catra?” Adora feigns innocence, “Don’t like it when I flirt with you?”
Catra stops again, her ears flicker around her head as she feels heat burning up under her fur, “Wait… are you being serious right now?”
“About?”
“The flirting?”
Adora this time turns away with a blush, but nods all the same.
“Okay, wow.” Catra says more to herself as a smile breaks out and spreads across her face, “Are you sure that’s a good idea?”
“What? Flirting?” Adora asks looking up sheepishly, “Nothing wrong with flirting…”
“Is it just flirting though?” Catra begins to walk again, “Because if you’re just doing this for shits and giggles then… stop.”

Adora startles at that, “I didn’t…”
“Just, don’t.” Catra says deflated, “If I don’t get this piece of shit back to Griff in time, I’m going to be done half my friend group. Not to mention, Trap’s is totally going to kill me.”
“Catra.” Adora pulls the magicat to a stop, “Put Stone down, please.”
“No way.” Catra frowns back, “I’m not letting them get away.”
“You knocked them out.” Adora tells her.
“You don’t know that for sure.” Catra says, “I’m not giving them the chance. Just because they can’t shapeshift, doesn’t mean they can’t run.”
“So what?” Adora rolls her eyes, “There’s two of us. I’m sure we’d be able to catch them.”
“Still no.” Catra says reluctantly, “Not until we get back to the lab.”
Adora takes a deep breath in and then says, “I’m not going to stop.”
“What?”
“You heard me.” Adora crosses her arms over her chest, “I’m not going to stop.”
“Why?”
“Do I really need to spell it out to you?” Adora says incredulously, “Are you really that dumb?”
“I have no idea what you’re talking about.” Catra definitely knows what she’s talking about but plays dumb regardless, “Spell it out to me.”
“I’m not going to stop flirting with you.” Adora says in one breath out.
“And… why is that?” Catra teases.
“You know why.” Adora mumbles.
“Ugh! You two are fucking annoying!” Stone grumbles from over Catra’s shoulder, “Just fuck already and get it over with.”
“Shut the fuck up, Stoner.” Catra readjust them on her shoulder making them growl out, “We’re in the middle of something.”
“Yeah, well it’s fucking annoying. Ow! Oof…” Stone passes out again as Catra drop them to the ground and knocks them out again.
Catra steps back up and faces Adora, a shit-eating grin on her face, “Where were we?”

Adora shoves Catra by the shoulder as the magicat grabs Adora's shoving arm and pulls the blonde up to her, nice and close, their faces barely apart, as Adora's eyes widen at the sudden closeness as she becomes breathless in Catra's grasp.
"Uh, hi." Adora manages to get out still breathless.
"Would you be against me and you…" Catra starts as she leans in and Adora's eyes go even wider with the unasked question, the magicat stops just before their lips touch, daring the blonde to close the distance, "Well?"
"Fuck…" Adora closes the distance and their lips come together in a soft kiss that leave the blonde light headed.
Catra pulls back after a moment, a grin on her face, "Breathe, princess. You're going to pass out and think this was all a dream."
Adora nods, still riding the high of the kiss, before remembering that she needs to breathe and takes a few vital breaths in, "Uh… that was…"
"…was?" Catra goads ghosting Adora's lips before leaning in for another kiss.
"Wow."
Catra grins again, "Yeah." And then looks down, "Stone."
"Huh?"
"Stone. We need to get them back to Entrapta's lab first." Catra says breaking Adora out of her breathless state, "Are you good?"
"Uh huh!" Adora snaps herself out of it, "Stone. Yes. Right…"
"Reckon you can carry them for a bit?" Catra asks stretching out her limbs, "Fucker is heavy."
Adora laughs, "Yeah, I can do that." She looks at Stone and then back at Catra, "Are we good?"
"Super good." Catra replies with a huge grin, "Better than super good."
"Yeah." Adora agrees mirroring the grin on the magicat's face, "Oh, I'm going to… you know."
"Go She-Ra?"
"Yeah, that." Adora chuckles.
"Go for it, princess." Catra replies as she checks on Stone and Adora transforms into She-Ra, the magicat pulls Stone up from the ground, "All yours, babe."
She-Ra blushes at the pet name, "Babe, huh?"

“Calling it like I see it.” Catra replies as She-Ra throws Stone over one shoulder, “Come on, let’s get back.”

“Catra! She-Ra!” Entrapta greets them when they come through the doors of her lab, “You got Stone!”
“Yeah, we did.” Catra nods to She-Ra, “Tell me you have something to keep them from running.”
“Of course!” Entrapta beams, “It’s not quite done yet, though.”
“Oh, okay.” Catra turns to She-Ra, “Traps has a secret… room.”
“Okay…” She-Ra replies looking between the pair, “Where?”
“I’ll show you!” Entrapta bounces off her chair and bounds towards She-Ra, “Follow!”
“Hey Traps! You got snacks?” Catra calls out as Entrapta shows She-Ra where to put Stone.
“You know where!” Entrpata shouts back.
“Right.” Catra chuckles to herself and raids Entrapta’s stash of tiny foods and a few drinks to go with it, hauling the stash back to her room and putting it in the middle of the bed, the drinks go on the bedside table as she strips out of her clothes and pulls on some clean clothes so she can lie on her bed.
“There you are.” Adora returns and eyes the stash of food on the bed, “Really?”
“Yes.” Catra takes her side of the bed, rolling to the side to face the food and starts to pop a few pieces into her mouth, “Hungry?”
“Stars, yes!” Adora starts to dive onto the bed when Catra quickly stops her, “What?”
“Not in your dirty clothes, princess.” Catra challenges the blonde.
Adora looks around, making sure the door is shut before stripping out of her clothes and making her way to the bed, “Not a word. I’m hungry and I don’t care if I’m half naked.”
“I’m not complaining.” Catra eyes the blonde before clearing her throat, “There’s drinks on the table behind you.”
“Oh, thank you!” Adora turns over and Catra tilts her head to get a better view of her butt, grinning at the sight as Adora rolls back, “Did you just look at my butt?”
“Yep.” Catra replies without any hesitation, “Yes I did.”
“Oh, okay.” Adora takes a long sip, “Ahh! I didn’t realise how

thirsty I was."
Catra licks her lips, but it's not thirst from lack of water that's making her thirsty, the magicat turning over and grabbing her own drink, "So… I was thinking…"
Adora nods, her mouth full of food as she waits for Catra to continue.
"Do you want to come to the Zone with me?" Catra asks, "Get Stone to Griff and get my friend back?"
"Yeah?"
"Yeah."
"And… then I can take them back to Bright Moon?" Adora asks after swallowing down the food in her mouth and Catra's throat feels dry again watching the muscles move on Adora's body by simply existing, the blonde notices and smiles, "Hello? Catra? Are you there?"
"Uh, what?" Catra shakes her head but her eyes can't stop roaming Adora's body as the blonde smirks at her, "What did you say?"
Adora shoves Catra's face with her hand playfully, "Get your mind out of the gutter."
Catra comes back with an awkward chuckle, "Sorry. I just… wow."
Adora rolls her eyes, "If I distract you this much, I guess I better put some clothes on."
"Uh, what?" Catra tries to refocus and fails as Adora gets off the bed and finds some of Catra's clothes as she puts on a loose tshirt and a pair of short before getting back on the bed. The magicat's eyes still on Adora as Catra licks her lips again, "Fuck… I love seeing you in my clothes."
"And here I thought you were some kind of Casanova." Adora laughs at Catra's slack-jaw expression still staring at her, "I had no idea this is your move."
"Huh?" Catra shakes her head again, "What are we talking about?"
"Stone." Adora steers the conversation back, "I can take them back to Bright Moon once we get your friend back?"
"Oh, yeah. Sure. Whatever you want." Catra replies, draining the rest of her drink, "I think I'm going to get some Z's."
"Yeah, that sounds like a good idea." Adora agrees with a yawn,

“Clear the bed first?”
“Yeah.” Catra gets up and grabs what’s left of the food and places it on the table, “I’m just going to turn off the lights.”
Catra gets back into bed, sliding under the blanket, rolling onto her side to face Adora who stares back with bright eyes. The magicat’s eyes reflecting in the low lights as Adora moves closer, “Hi.”
“Hey, Adora.” Catra rasps and before she knows she’s even doing it, she’s leaning in, pressing her lips onto Adora’s for a soft kiss, “I’ll wake you up in a few hours when Traps is done.”
Adora pulls Catra back in for another kiss, “Okay.”
Catra smiles as she rests her head back down on the pillow facing Adora, the blonde turning over and scooting back towards the magicat, Catra whispers, “I never thought the mighty She-Ra was such a little spoon.”
“I’m not She-Ra. Not right now.” Adora whispers back with a yawn.
“Yeah, you’re right.” Catra pulls Adora into her a little more, wrapping her arms around the blonde, “You’re Adora. And Adora is… magnificent.”

Chapter End Notes

Stone has finally been caught!

I've been away for work and it's been... exhausting, so writing has been kind of difficult.
I'm on the road again next week so I'm tossing up whether to bring my laptop with me or not...
It's going to be 30+ degrees where I'm going so... I might give next week a miss for writing, until I get back anyways.
Climbing, driving and writing... let me think...

Thanks for reading, kudos and commenting!

Stay out of the Water!

Chapter Summary

Catra and Adora bring Stone to Griff to get the bounty.

Chapter Notes

I'm back home!
So... new chapter! Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"You know… I can probably ask Glimmer to just teleport us to the Zone, right?" Adora points out as Catra takes up the spot at the back, Stone in the middle and Adora leading from the front, "It'd be a lot faster."
"Yeah, I don't trust Sparkles." Catra replies curtly, "It's obvious she doesn't like me, let alone trust me. And as such, I don't trust her."
Adora sighs, "You're right. But, she really is sorry."
"Yeah. I'll believe it when I hear it from the horse's mouth." Catra grunts back.
Stone laughs out in the middle, "Of course you'd get on the bad side of the literal queen."
"Shut the fuck up, Stone." Catra growls from behind them, "I'm only on her bad side because you tricked her into thinking you were some innocent child."
Stone laughs again, "Yeah, that was a good one. Tricked blondie here too." Adora turns back with a glare, but that doesn't deter the shapeshifter, "Made slaughtering that family all the more… fun. Oh, the irony of Angel being the literal angel of death."
"You're a sick fuck." Catra grunts out, "What the fuck is wrong with you?"
Stone shrugs, "Just special, I guess."
"You're not special." Adora seethes, turning back to face the front, "You're just evil."
"Eh, like I care what you think." Stone replies, "Oh, by the way, once we're back in the Zone, I'm going to kill Griff, your friend

that you're trying to save and everyone else in that hellhole."
"Kill Griff and all those other Zone fuckers for all I care." Catra says offhandedly, "Touch my friend and I'm going to make you hurt."
"Ha!" Stone throws their head back with a mock laugh, "Once these restraints come off, you'll really see what kind of a monster I can be."
"Yeah?" Catra taunts, "And when that happens, I'll be there to kill you."
"Ahem!" Adora interrupts them, "No. I'm going to take you back to Bright Moon and you'll be punished for your crimes."
"Which is probably death." Catra unhelpfully points out.
"Great." Stone rolls their eyes, "So, I'm dead either way."
"No one said you were going to be put to death in Bright Moon." Adora says, "You'll probably get jail time or something."
"Are you fucking kidding me, princess?" Catra groans, "This fuckwit is going to escape whatever prison you're going to put them in."
"Hey! I don't make the rules!" Adora argues, "It's the right thing to do. They need to pay for what they've done."
Stone starts to snicker as Catra growls at them, "Shut it, Stone. You still have to get through Griff first." And with that, Stone deflates a little, "Or did you forget about that?"
"I haven't forgotten about that." Stone scoffs out, "If you asked me, he deserved what I did to him."
"One bad turn doesn't make up for another." Catra says, "You didn't have to frame my friend."
"Oh, come on!" Stone whines, "It's not my fault your friend is dense as fuck."
"She thought you were her girlfriend!" Catra shouts out angrily, "She was looking out for the person she loved. Not that you have any idea what that is."
"Whatever." Stone scoffs again, "Love is for the weak."
"Okay, shut up and keep moving." Catra grumbles out.
"Wait…" Stone looks between the pair and then smirks, "You're weak."
"Shut the fuck up." Catra repeats with a growl.
"You're totally in love with blondie here, aren't you?" Stone

deduces and licks their teeth happily, “Oh, that’s fantastic…”
“I said, shut the fuck up!” Catra shouts out, grabbing Stone by the collar and lifting her arm up, claws out as she rages, “Keep talking and I will claw your tongue out.”
“Catra.” Adora says trying to diffuse the situation, “They aren’t worth it.”
Stone snickers, “Oh, I am going enjoy slowly killing Adora…” they look at Adora, “And I think I’m going to film it so you can watch my handiwork.”
Catra loses it and slashes angrily at Stone, three distinct claw mark grace their face as they quickly cover it with their hands.
Adora pulls Stone back before Catra can get another swipe in, “Catra! Stop!”
Catra growls out, “Griff never said I couldn’t maim them.”
“Let Griff deal with them first.” Adora tries to negotiate, “And then…” she looks at Stone and narrows her eyes with a serious look on her face, “whatever happens after that… you get first crack.”
“What?!” Stone shouts out, “You can’t be serious! You’re supposed to be the good guy!”
Adora smirks, crossing her arms over her chest, “I am the good guy.”
Stone just stares at her as Adora turns back around, they grunt when they’re nudged forward, “Move. Keep walking.” Catra grunts out, “The sooner Griff kills you the faster and better the world will be.”

“Here we are.” Catra announces happily as Stone stops in place, looking ahead at the large metal doors that lead back into the Zone, “Home sweet home, right, Stoner?”
“Fuck off.” Stone curses under their breath.
“Alright, come on.” Catra says and waits for Stone to move, but they don’t, “I said move.”
“Yeah, not happening.” Stone replies, digging their feet into the ground, “There’s no way I’m going in there.”
“Fine. Have it your way.” Catra huffs out, “Adora, would you do the honours?”

“Huh? Adora tilts her head at the magicat, not really sure what she’s talking about until Catra gestures to the blonde and pretends to do the whole *Honour of Grayskull* schtick as Adora finally gets it, “Oh, yeah. No problems.”
Adora transforms into She-Ra as Catra just smirks at the shapeshifter, “If you aren’t going to walk in, then She-Ra will haul you in.”
Stone’s eyes widen at the sight of an angry She-Ra in front of them, “Touch me and that’s assault.”
She-Ra looks to Catra for guidance as the magicat rolls her eyes, “Dude, seriously? Assault?” Catra scoffs out, “You’ve killed families. Be thankful I need you alive to get my friend back or I would have put you down myself.”
“What happened to two wrongs don’t make a right?” Stone goads.
Catra shrugs, “Like I fucking care.”
“Woah!” She-Ra steps between the pair, “Enough. Stop.”
Catra glares at Stone once more before looking at She-Ra and sighing, “If they won’t walk willingly, can you carry them inside?”
“Yes. I can do that.” She-Ra replies and then looks at Stone, “Are you going to walk or am I going have to carry you inside?”
“Oh, my legs.” Stone dramatically falls to the ground, “Looks like you’re going to have to carry me.”
“Okay.” She-Ra grins as she picks them up and tosses them roughly over her shoulder before yelping and dropping Stone to the ground, “Hey!”
Stone smirks up, “What’s wrong?”
She-Ra glares down at them as Catra pulls them up by the collar of their shirt, “You think that’s funny?”
“Yeah. It’s a hoot.” Stone grins defiantly, “It’s not often I get to grope a princess.”
“They touch you inappropriately?” Catra asks She-Ra and she nods, an angry look on her face as Catra bares her teeth at them, “Well… let me even up the score then.”

WHACK!

“Oof!” Stone goes down, clutching their non-lawed cheek as Catra shakes out her fist, “You’ll pay for that.”
“Call it even.” Catra growls, “Touch her inappropriately again and

I'll cut off the part of you that reproduces."
"Touchy." Stone stays down on the ground, "Go ahead. Hurt me. I know you want to."
Catra's raises her arm when She-Ra quickly stops her, "It's not worth it."
"Fine." Catra lowers her arm down and growls out frustratingly, "Get them up, please."
"Sure." She-Ra lifts them up and back to their feet, "Move."
"No."
"Fuck this." Catra grunts out, "Wait here. Don't let them out of your sight."
She-Ra nods, "Wait! Where are you going?"
"If Stone isn't going to go to the Zone, the Zone is coming to them." Catra calls out as she runs towards the metal doors, knocking on it hard as She-Ra watches over the shapeshifter, "Hey! Open up!"
"Who goes there?!" A gruff voice comes over a statically speaker located just outside the metal doors, "Answer!"
"I've got the bounty!" Catra shouts back out, "Open the fucking doors!"
"I don't see the bounty. Where are they?" The voice asks.
"They are refusing to come to the door." Catra shouts out again, "So, come out and get them!"
"I don't see the bounty." The voice repeats, "Bring them here and we will open the doors."
"Oh, for fuck's sakes!" Catra growls out, "They're just over there!" She points towards them as she shouts out, "Open the fucking door!"
"Bring them here!" The voice demands, "The door stays shut until you can prove you have the bounty!"
"Fuck!" Catra growls out, "Fine."
She runs back towards She-Ra, grabs Stone by the cuffs and starts to dragging them to the door, "No!" they shout out, "No!"
She-Ra pushes them from behind as they bring Stone towards the door, "Move!"
Catra picks them up and tosses Stone against the metal doors, making a loud thump against the doors as Catra looks up at the camera and growls, "There! There's the bounty. Now, open the

fucking doors!”
There’s a moment of silence before the doors creak open and a large figure approaches from the other side, silhouetted by the sun as Catra and She-Ra take a step back as Stone curls up into a ball. The figure picks up Stone by the leg and starts to drag them inside, a gruff, “Follow.” Is all they say as the doors begin to close. Catra and Adora quickly jump inside and follow the figure.

“Ah, Catra. You’re back. And with Stone.” Griff the Gorgeous greets sleazily, “Oh, and who is this beautiful creature you have with you?”
She-Ra furrows her brows at him as Catra shakes her head, “This is She-Ra.”
“The legendary She-Ra?” Catra nods, “Oh, what a treat.”
“Look, can we get this over with already?” Catra groans, “Where is Scorpia?”
“Shush, Catra.” Griff scolds the magicat, “We’ll get to the trade soon enough. Let me just talk with She-Ra first.” He slicks back his hair and gives his best suave face, “Hello, She-Ra. How would you like to join me for dinner? Maybe something more later?”
“No, thank you.” She-Ra politely refuses the offer, “I’m not hungry.”
Griff quirks a perfectly manicured eyebrow back at the blonde, “You might not be hungry… but I am.”
“Gross.” Catra sticks her tongue out.
“Shut it!” Griff growls out at the magicat before he gets an idea, “She-Ra.”
“Yes?”
“I have a proposition for you and your cat friend.” Griff grins smugly as She-Ra looks on irritated.
“What proposition?” She-Ra asks, knowing whatever Griff has in mind is going to be horrible.
“Well, I’ll set Scorpia free if you have dinner with me, tonight.” He proposes with a smirk.
“What?!” Catra shouts out, “That was not part of the deal! I’ve brought you Stone now you give me my friend!”
She-Ra crosses her arms over her chest, “No. The original deal

stands. Hand over Scorpia."
"Mm… no." Griff replies, snapping his fingers as a few guards pick up Stone and haul him into the back somewhere, "No deal. I think I'll keep Stone and kill your friend. Maybe I'll kill both of them at the same time."
"No." She-Ra steps forward, brandishing her sword aggressively, "Hand over Scorpia, now."
"No." Griff repeats, "I don't think I will." He grins evilly, "Oh, and good luck finding her unless…"
"I'm not having dinner with you." She-Ra growls out.
"Okay, have it your way then." Griff waves them off, "Execution it is, then." He snaps his fingers again and his guards start to advance on Catra and She-Ra while he gets up, "Too bad. You could have been screaming out my name in ecstasy."
Catra laughs out at that, "From all reports, you don't last longer than a minute!"
Griff glares back but doesn't take the bait, "Dinner would have been exquisite too." Then he turns to his guards, "Kill them."
"Attack!" The guards shout and start pulling out their weapons at the pair, "You heard the boss! Kill them!"
"Fuck…" Catra growls as her claws slide out, "I totally should have eaten breakfast and lunch today…"
"Don't worry, Catra." She-Ra says, "We'll be fine."
"Says the superhero that's bulletproof and sword-proof!" Catra scoffs as she starts to duck under the swings of weapons and gun fire, "This is not good…"
"I got this!" She-Ra grins, swinging her sword with precise movements, energy smiting down the enemy quickly as she sheathes her sword and smirks at Catra, "Done."
"Show off." Catra grumbles as she gets off the ground after dodging the gun fire, dusting herself off, "We need to get to Griff the Gross."
"Okay." She-Ra nods, "Also, what the fuck was that?"
"What?"
"He was totally hitting on me!" She-Ra groans, "Do I not scream 'gay' to you?!"
Catra looks up at She-Ra in amusement before shrugging, "You're hot in She-Ra form."

She-Ra blushes at that and then whines, “Yeah, but you’re the demographic I’m targeting.”
“Your demographic is gay magicats?” Catra says with a smirk.
“No!” She-Ra huffs out.
“No?”
“Ugh! It’s gay women!” She-Ra huffs out, pouting in the process.
“Oh, so… gay women…” Catra repeats slowly.
She-Ra rolls her eyes, transforming back into Adora, “What does this form scream out?”
Catra looks Adora up and down and then smiles, “That you’re Catra-sexual.”
“Oh, my stars!” Adora can’t help but laugh, she nods regardless, “You’re right. I totally am.” Then she smirks back at Catra, “So… does that make you… Adora-sexual?”
“Yes. Very much so.” Catra readily agrees.
“What about… She-Ra-sexual?” Adora teases a little more.
“Eh, like I said. Not really into the whole muscly women thing. But I’m also not opposed to it.” Catra shrugs before grabbing Adora’s hand, “Come on, we have to save Scorpia.”
“Right.” Adora looks around as Catra pulls her along, “Do you know where she is?”
“Yeah, kinda.” Catra replies, “I figured Griff wasn’t going to be forthcoming with the trade so I had Trap’s make something else for me.”
“Like?”
“A tracker for Scorpia.” Catra replies, “I know she’s got chips in us.”
“What?!”
“Yeah, I think it’s her way of saying that she cares about us.” Catra replies as she pulls out the tracking device, “Good thing too, right?”
“…I guess?” Adora says unsurely, “That’s sort of… wrong?”
“We consented to it.” Catra replies, “Besides, if it makes her feel better knowing where we are, then I’m alright with it.”
“Okay.” Adora finally understands, “How far away is your friend?”
“She’s on the move by the looks of things.” Catra says, “Griff must be moving her.”
“Do you think he’s really going to… you know… execute her?”

Adora asks nervously, “Would he do something like that?”
“He literally just tried to kill us, princess.” Catra deadpans back to the blonde, “So, yes. He would do something like that.”
“That’s… not good.” Adora says.
“Yeah, not good at all.” Catra agrees, “So, the sooner we get to her, the sooner we can get out.”
“What about Stone? Won’t they escape?” Adora frowns down, “Once they take off the cuffs and ankle bracelet, won’t Stone just… get out?”
“Probably.” Catra replies undeterred, “Look, that’s a problem for future Catra and Adora. Right now, present Catra and Adora need to save Scorpia.”
“Okay. You’re right. One thing at a time.” Adora agrees as they make their way further into the Zone, “What about Griff?”
“What about that creep?” Catra stops Adora and pushes then back into the shadows of the walls, “Shh…”
A few guards make their way past, chatting loudly and laughing as Catra and Adora stay quiet. Once they are gone, Adora breathes out, accidentally leaning in too close to the magicat’s ear and having it flick into her face, “Catra!” she whisper shouts as Catra turns her head to look at the blonde questioning, “Sorry…”
Catra peeks out before grabbing Adora’s hand, “Come on, she’s this way.”

“AH!” Stone screams out in pain as Griff cuts their cheek with his knife as the shapeshifter is chained up again the wall, “Stop! Please!”
“No.” Griff grins before pointing to the small scar on his face, “You’re going to pay for doing this to me and my formally perfect face.”
“AH!” Stone screams again as Griff makes another cut on the opposite cheek, the shapeshifter hisses this time, struggling against the restraints, “Fuck you! Fuck you and your ugly ass face!”
Griff glares at Stone angrily, “What did you say about my face?” He brings the knife up to Stone’s throat, tilting the shapeshifter’s neck up, “Say it again. I dare you.”

Stone tries not to swallow as they wince when they feel the blade press into their skin, keeping quiet and biting down on their tongue as Griff just stares into their yellow eyes.
"That's what I thought." Griff grins before removing the knife and then gut punching Stone.
"Oof!" Stone slouches forward a little as Griff laughs.
"You know what I don't get?" Griff point the knife towards the shapeshifter, "If I had your abilities, I would be using to take the form of the lovers of the people I want to sleep with."
"You're sick." Stone breathes out, causing Griff to laugh.
"You're one to talk." Griff moves so that they are face to face, "You kill women and children for fun. Who's really the sick one here?"
"You both are!" Catra shouts out as she barges in through the door, She-Ra right behind her, "Where are you taking Scorpia?!"
"Oh, it's you two." Griff says uninterested, even yawning to prove his point, "What are you doing here? Can't you see I'm busy?"
Catra walks straight up to him as She-Ra pushes back Griff's guards, the magicat standing toe to toe with him, "One more time. Where is Scorpia?"
Griff rolls his eyes, clearly over this conversation, "Check the river."
"What?!" Catra's eyes widen.
"Oh, you better hurry." Griff sneers, "She's got roughly…" he thinks to himself, "Ten minutes of air left, if you know what I mean."
The ensuing cackles has Catra feeling murderous, She-Ra pulls her back, "We don't have much time left!"
Catra snarls out at Griff, "You'll get yours. Trust me on that."
"Nice threat." Griff laughs harder, "Now, please fuck off. I'm busy here."
Catra shoves Griff back and then takes off in a sprint towards the river, She-Ra hot on he heels as they rush through the Zone and towards the river.

"Over there!" Catra points out, "Fuck!"
"What is it?!" She-Ra asks before her eyes widen, "Are those…?"
"Crocodiles? Yeah. Those aren't logs." Catra looks around at where her friend is submerged underwater in a glass cage with no holes,

“Well, at least she’s safe in there. Until her air runs out…”
“What should we do?” She-Ra asks, “I don’t think I’m really up for fighting crocodiles…”
“I don’t expect you to.” Catra replies much to She-Ra relief, the magicat looks around and sees something, “I have an idea.”

“Scorp! Are you okay in there?” Catra shouts out carefully as she climbs across the tree branch where Scorpia’s soon to be glass coffin hangs off, the branch bends dangerously close to snapping as Catra slowly edges closer, “Scorp! Can you hear me?”
“Be careful, Catra!” She-Ra shouts as she holds onto the rope around Catra’s waist in case the branch should break.
Catra nods in reply, keeping her focus on the glass box beneath her, “Okay, big gal…” the magicat reaches down to the rope holding the glass box in the water and tries to tug it up, but it’s too heavy, “Fuck me…”
“What’s wrong?!”
“It’s too heavy!” Catra shouts back, “I need a distraction!”
“What?!”
Catra goes back to the safety of the tree and to where She-Ra waits, “I need you to get the crocs away from here.”
“How?!”
Catra thinks for a bit, “I’ve got it!” she quickly rips off a branch higher up, a long piece and holds it out to She-Ra, “Slap the water with this over the far side. That should get their attention.”
“What about you?”
“When the crocs leave, I’ll get Scorp out.” Catra says.
“Are you sure about this?” She-Ra takes the branch.
“No. But I’m all out of ideas.” Catra admits and She-Ra nods, “Just, get out of there if they start getting too close. Got me?”
“Yeah.” She-Ra says.
“Okay. Go. Now.” Catra tells She-Ra with as much confidence as she can in this half brained plan, “And be careful!”
“You too!” She-Ra pecks Catra on the lips real quick and then takes off.
Catra watches as She-Ra gets into position and then when then blonde is at the river, Catra gives her the go ahead and the blonde

princess starts slapping the water with the branch, creating as much noise and disruption as she can.
Slowly the crocodiles get curious and begin to swim towards the disturbance as Catra starts to move back to the end of the branch again, waiting for the last crocodile she can see leave. Once she's certain that the area is clear, she descends the rope and lands softly on top of the glass box.

SNAP!

"FUCK!" Catra falls into the water as a hidden crocodile goes for her, she quickly dives under and wrestles with the creature, before being dragged back top side, where she manages to punch it a few times before digging her claws into it's hard skin. The crocodile shakes her off and just when she thinks it's going to come back, it surprises her and swims away. The magicat breathes in and out hard, before remembering that Scorpia is still in the glass cage. Catra swims as calmly back to the cage and her friend lights up at seeing the magicat.
"Wildcat!" Scorpia's voice is muffled by the water and the glass cage as Catra cuts a hole in the side of the cage with her claws, water quickly rushing into it as Scorpia pushes herself out, grabbing the magicat in her arms, "Wildcat! You came back!"
"Pleasantries later, Scorp! We need to get out of this water!" Catra shrugs out of the Scorpia's arms, her friend quickly remembering the dangers as they both quickly and calmly get back to the shore.
Just as they reach the shore, Catra shouts out in pain, "Fuck!"
A crocodile has snapped onto her leg as she was exiting the water and starts to drag her back into the water, "Catra!" Scorpia quickly grabs onto Catra's arms, trying to pull her back, "Gosh! Come on, Wildcat!"
"Let go!" Catra shouts out when she sees the crocodile getting ready to deathroll, "Let go!"
Scorpia reluctantly lets go as the crocodile starts spinning, Catra doing her best to roll with it so not to lose her leg in the process, and then she feels herself being dragged back into the water, she takes a deep breathe in as she's submerged under.

“Catra!” Scorpia shouts out from the safety of the bank and behind a fallen tree, “Catra!”
She-Ra appears and looks around, before turning to Scorpia, “Where’s Catra?”
Scorpia points at the water.
“What happened?” She-Ra asks, hoping that it’s not what she thinks it is.
“Crocodile took her.” Scorpia replies with a shaky voice, “It dragged her under…”
She-Ra’s eyes widen, “No. Catra!”
Scorpia quickly grabs She-Ra by the wrist, “No! Are you crazy?!”
“I have to help her!” She-Ra shrugs off Scorpia’s grasp but as she takes a few steps forward she has to quickly retreat when a crocodile lunges at her out of the water, “Woah!”
“Yeah, I know.” Scorpia quickly pulls She-Ra back behind the safety of the tree, “I… I think…”
“Don’t say it.” She-Ra stares out at the water, “Don’t.”
Scorpia nods, swallowing down hard as tears start to well up in her eyes. Under her breath she whispers, “Come on, Wildcat…”
She-Ra continues to stare out at the water, “Come on, Catra…”

A burst of water splashes across the river as Catra appears on top of the crocodile that had dragged her down. She growls out as it dives down again, taking the magicat under as She-Ra and Scorpia both look on in horror.
“Catra!” They pair both shout from the bank, looking for some way to save the magicat.
“Fuck!” Catra growls out as she appears out of the water again, her arms wrapped around the reptile as she once again disappears under the water again.
She-Ra and Scorpia watch on, not sure what to do now.
Bubbles appear from where Catra had just submerged until the water goes still again.
Scorpia stares out, her mouth open as she murmurs, “Do you think…?”

"I… I don't know…" She-Ra murmurs back as they both stand there in shock, "Is she…?"
"Grrr-agh!" Catra shouts out as she reappears again, this time much closer to shore as Scorpia and She-Ra both rush out, grabbing an arm each and drag Catra back to the safety of the bank and behind the fallen tree. The magicat pants hard as She-Ra and Scorpia lay her down on the ground and assess her as Catra winces in pain, hissing as she tries to move her leg.
"Don't move!" She-Ra tells her as she does a quick once over.
"The croc…" Catra grits out.
Scorpia looks over the tree and the crocodile is on the bank, closer to the water, but it's on its back, "I think you got it, Wildcat." Her friend says and Catra breathes out in relief, before she looks back up and grimaces.
"What?" Catra asks despite the pain she's in.
"Uh… I guess crocodiles are cannibals…" Scorpia just says as she looks away and down at the magicat, "Are you okay?"
"No." Catra hisses, "My… my leg."
"I got this." She-Ra says smiling down at Catra, "Scorpia, can you give us a minute?"
"Uh, sure… I guess." Scorpia replies, getting up and taking a few steps back.
"Thank you." She-Ra says before pulling Catra up into her arms, the magicat hisses again in pain, "Sorry…"
"It's okay.' Catra grunts out and then is blinded by white light so bright she has to close her eyes. When she opens them, Adora's face to face with her and the pain in her leg is nothing more but a dull thrum, she looks down at her leg and then back to Adora, "How did you do that?"
Adora just smiles back before frowning down at the magicat, "You scared me!"
"I scared you?!" Catra throws right back, "I nearly died!"
"I know!" Adora argues right back, "Are you crazy!?"
"I had to save Scorp!" Catra reasons.
"You nearly died!" Adora shouts back, unable to hold back her emotions as Catra's ears pin back in guilt as Adora repeats a lot more softly, "You nearly died…"
"I know. I'm sorry." Catra slumps down into Adora's arms, "That

was just…”
And before Catra can finish that sentence, Adora is kissing her with everything she’s got.
When they pull apart, Scorpia looks at Catra with a shit eating grin, “So… how long has this been going on for?”
Catra rolls her eyes as Adora laughs, the magicat sighing, “Not long at all.”
“Uh huh…” Scorpia pretends to think about that, “I told you, didn’t I?”
“Shut up.” Catra grumbles.
“Told her what?” Adora asks.
“Told her that she would fall in love for real.” Scorpia replies so proudly that it makes Catra groan in embarrassment, “Oh, there’s no reason to be shy about it, Wildcat!”
“I’m not shy.” Catra groans again, “Can we go now?”
“Catra totally loves me.” Adora teases.
“Wait, what?” Catra’s ears perk up.
Adora laughs before she realises what she just said and blushes hard, “Uh…”
“Oh, look at you two love birds!” Scorpia gushes, “I can’t wait to tell Perfuma!”

Chapter End Notes

They've got Scorp back!

Thanks for reading, kudos and commenting!

I'm back from my work trip up north.
Pretty sure I spent most of that time dehydrated... but I'm all good now!

Shapeshifting

Chapter Summary

Final chapter - will Stone and Griff take each other out?

Chapter Notes

Apologies for dragging this last chapter out - but at least the previous chapter was a cliffhanger... right?
Anyways, enjoy!

CW - Violence/Blood/Gore

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“So… what’s the plan?” Scorpia asks a little too loudly making Catra pull her friend back down against the wall they are hiding behind while they watch Griff torture Stone, her friend whispers softer, “I know they basically put me on death row… but gosh, we can’t just let them get tortured to death…”
Catra peeks over and then promptly hides back down again before shrugging, “I really don’t have a problem with this.”
Scoria frowns at her, as does Adora, “Wildcat! You’re better than this!” she whisper shouts in a scolding tone, “This is just wrong.”
“What they did to you, both of them, was wrong.” Catra simply states, “So, I really couldn’t care less. They hurt you, both of them.”
“I know. I was there.” Scorpia points out with a reassuring smile on her face, “But it’s still not right to let Griff do this to them.”
“Yeah, and what do you suggest we do?” Catra shakes her head, “I say we let them cancel each other out.”
“What about their punishment? You said I would be able to take them back to Bright Moon.” Adora says.
“Go ahead then. Take them.” Catra gestures for Adora to follow through with her plan, “I’ll be here if you need me.”
“You’re not going to help? Like, at all?” Adora asks with a slight frown on her face before shaking her head.

Catra groans out softly, “Fine. I’ll help you guys with whatever stupidity this is.” The magicat peeks over again and then rolls her neck before addressing the both of them, “Mark my words. This rescue mission or whatever you want to call it is going to be a giant waste of time when they end up killing each other.”
“You don’t know that!” Adora huffs out, “But we can’t let Griff just torture them to death.”
Over arguing, Catra just nods back defeatedly, “Okay, I’ll create a diversion while you two get that asshole, Stone.”
“Uh… how do you plan to do that?” Scorpia asks grimacing at the half hatched plan.
“Easy.” Catra stretches out her arms and then tests her newly repaired leg, the thrum not so bad as she lets her claws slide out, “Get ready.”
“Hey, what?!” Adora manages to say before Catra is up and out of their hiding place and then sprinting out straight towards Griff and slashing him across the face, right over his left eye as he screams out in shock and pain, “Catra!” Adora calls out as she grunts out annoyed, grabbing Scorpia and getting out into the open.
“You!” Griff growls out as Catra stands between him and Stone, “You’re supposed to be dead!”
“I’m supposed to be a lot of things.” Catra replies as she flexes her arms, “Also, nice try with the glass box over a croc infested river. Too bad your plan sucked.”
Holding his bleeding eye, he looks around to his guards with his good eye glaringly, “Kill her! What the fuck are you waiting for?!”
“Attack!” Catra hears as she breathes out heavily and then starts to move around the room, dodging the advance of the guards and their attacks, “Don’t let her get out of here!” they yell out.
“Will you guys hurry up!” Catra shouts out to her companions as she dives and dodges the multiple strikes coming towards her, “I’m wasn’t planning on dying twice today!”
Griff turns and is automatically floored by a charging Scorpia, “Oof! Argh!” he groans out in pain as the large scorpini woman jabs him with her stinger, “You’ll… regret… this…” He manages to say before the effects of her poison start to take over and falls to the ground.
“Gosh, I really don’t like doing that…” Scorpia admits as she gets

up slowly, rubbing the back of her head awkwardly, "But I guess it's better than the alternative."
"Good work, Scorpia." Adora says.
"Will you guys, seriously, hurry up! Stop chit-chatting!" Catra growls out before grunting out when a stray fist makes contact with her face, "Oh, you are so going down for that!"
The guard that makes contact with Catra's face eyes widen in fear as he starts to run away, hoping that Catra will be too busy with the other guards to chase after him. Oh, but how wrong he is…
"Argh!" he shouts out, "Help! Help me!"
A swift punch to his face puts him out of his misery as the magicat just growls down at him, "Lucky I'm in a merciful mood, dickhead."
"Catra!" Adora shouts from where Stone is, the magicat turns back and seeing a group of five guards advancing on her as she gets ready to fight them off.
"Coming!" Scorpia calls out, running straight through the five of them at once as they all tumble and fall to the ground, she makes quick work of them with her stinger before stepping towards Catra, a pincer held out to the magicat, "Are you alright, Wildcat?"
"Just peachy." Catra grumbles as she accepts Scorpia's help to get up, "Stone?"
"Adora's getting them." Scorpia informs as they walk back to the other room, seeing Adora just stand in front of the shapeshifter with a perplexed look on her face, "Hi, Adora. What's wrong?"
"I have no idea how this whole… system works." Adora replies still looking at how Stone is held up in the torture chamber, "There isn't exactly… locks?"
"There should be a switch somewhere." Catra looks around, "Maybe some sort of control console?"
"Come on, geniuses!" Stone chastises, "Get me out of this!"
"Shut the fuck up, Stone!" Catra growls at them, "Or we'll just leave you here!"
"No, you won't." Stone challenges, "Blondie and your muscly friend here won't let that happen."
"I said, shut the fuck up!" Catra repeats now getting into their face.
"Catra!" Adora puts her hand on the magicat's shoulder, "It's not

worth it. Bright Moon will punish them for their crimes there."
Stone starts to laugh upon hearing that, "Hear that, kitty cat? I'm going to be *punished* in Bright Moon."
"Yes. You will be punished severely in Bright Moon." Adora emphasises, "Now, do you know how this works or are we going to have to just leave you here?"
"I say just leave them here." Catra says stepping back and looks over to Griff lying unconscious not too far away, "I'm sure Griff hasn't got his rocks off yet on torturing this piece of shit."
Stone growls over at Catra, "Watch your mouth. Or I will…"
"You will what? Huh, Stone? What?" Catra taunts, "You're in no position to issue threats."
"Oh! I think I know!" Scorpia pipes up and then heads over to a hidden controller by the wall, "Now… which button was it again…?" she sees a green button and lights up, "Oh, it must be this one!"
"Argh! Fuck!" Stone screams out as a jolt of electricity goes through him, "What the fuck!?"
"Whoops… sorry." Scorpia sheepishly says before pressing a yellow button.
"Stars! Dammit! Fuck!" Stone screams out again as another jolt of electricity goes through him once more, "You're supposed to be helping me!"
"Why would all these buttons do the same thing?" Scorpia turns around exasperatedly, "It makes no sense!"
Catra laughs, "Just keep pressing buttons, Scorp!" she eggs her friend on, "I'm sure one of them is the release button."
Stone glares at her, "I'm going to kill you when I get out of this."
"Sure, you are." Catra brushes off the threat, "But until then… enjoy us trying to set you free."
"Actually… I'm going to kill blondie over there and then that giant crab over there." Stone grins evilly, "Oh, and I'm going to make you watch. It's going to so much fun."
"What makes you think you can kill either of them?" Catra tilts her head at them.
"Easy." Stone replies with the same feral grin, "But I'm not going to monologue my plan."
"Whatever." Catra moves to stand next to Adora, "I don't care

about your stupid plan because if you try anything, I will decapitate you."
Stone just smiles before it's instantly replaced with another scream as more electricity goes through his body as Scorpia tries another button.
"Sorry!" Scorpia calls out from the control panel, "There's only a few more buttons left!"
Catra smiles back at Stone, "Hear that, Stone? Only a few more buttons left."
Stone rolls their eyes with a groan as they let out another scream when Scorpia hits the wrong button again, "I swear that was an accident!"
"Fuck…" Stone grumbles under their breath, "Why are you even friends with that?"
"What the fuck did you just say?" Catra grabs Stone by the shirt and bares her fangs, "Don't you dare say anything bad about her. She's the one that took the fall for your crimes."
Stone starts to laugh in Catra's face, "She's weak."

BZZZ!

"Oof!" Catra goes down as Stone shoves her away forcefully once Scorpia hits the right button and releases them, "Guys! Get Stone!"
"Thank you." Stone grins as they quickly shapeshift into a large dark green dragon, fire breathing out of their nostrils as they bare their sharp teeth back at the magicat, "I look forward to watching you burn."
"Oh fuck." Catra manages to scurry away to safety as Adora and Scorpia jump out of the way and behind a wall to safety, "Adora! Scorp!"
"We're okay!" Adora shouts out at the sound of the dragon's footsteps stomping away, "What's happening?!"
Catra groans as she gets up to her feet, "I'll lead them away. You guys get out!"
"Catra! No!" Adora shouts out as Stone's heavy footsteps stop and then turn around, stomping away from them as she looks out, "Catra!"
The magicat sprints off in the opposite direction, turning back just

to see Stone stomping on top of Griff's unconscious body, squishing their captor and torturer in the process, Catra scrunches up her face upon hearing the sound of Griff's body flattening under Stone's foot.
Stone makes a noise of disgust, "Gross. Griff really was gross." They say as they try to shake off the remnants of his body from their foot, "This guy really was greasy."
Catra scoffs out, "I guess that's one down…" she looks back at Stone, "Come and get me, asshole!"
The sound of Stone's feet pounding on the floors has Catra running faster and out of the Zone's main doors, "I'm going to kill you!"
"Then fucking do it!" Catra goads as she pulls the heavy doors open before slamming them shut behind her just as Stone breathes out fire, "Fuck!" she grunts out as she burns her hands on the doors just as she got them shut.
The magicat runs towards the safety and shelter of the woods as the doors burst open and the dragon roars out loudly and angrily, breathing out more flames and setting the trees alight as Catra runs deeper into the woods.
"Stone!" She-Ra shouts out as the dragon turns around and breathes out flames towards her, "Oh crap!" she manages to block the flames with her sword's magic before taking over.
A wicked grin appears on Stone's face as they continue back towards the zone, breathing fire constantly at the gates before…
"Adora?! Are you okay?" Catra's voice rings out coming back towards She-Ra, "Adora!"
"Catra?!" She-Ra reappears, "Catra!"
"Hey! I'm here!" Catra runs over to the blonde, Adora pulling her into a hug, "I'm okay. I'm okay."
"Thank the stars!" She-Ra breathes out, "Where's Stone?"
"I don't know where they are." Catra says as she leans in further into She-Ra's body, "They must of went to the woods. It's on fire right now."
"Oh?" She-Ra looks over the magicat's shoulder and sees that it is on fire, "Are you alright?"
"Yeah. Stone got away though." Catra replies with a sigh, "We need to get them back."

“Yeah.” She-Ra agrees, “What form are they in?”
“The dragon still.” Catra replies quickly, “I think they went after Ca… I think they went that way.” The magicat points out of the gates and towards the burning woods.
“What did you say?” She-Ra pulls back slightly as Catra looks up her a little surprised.
“I said, I think they went that way.” Catra repeats.
“No. You said…” She-Ra starts and Catra’s demeanour changes, a feral grin on her face not like anything the blonde has seen before, “You’re… you’re Stone.”
Catra rolls her eyes, before lunging towards She-Ra but before she can, she’s knocked down to the ground by… Catra?
Scorpia rushes out, stopping right next to She-Ra, “Hey! I think I saw… what the?”
“Stone.” She-Ra frowns at the 2 Catra’s tussling in front of them, “One of them is Stone.”
“Uh…” Scorpia watches the pair of magicat’s duke it out, trying to figure out which one is her best friend and which one is the serial killer, “Do you know…?”
“Stay down!” One of the Catra’s slams the other magicat into the ground, pinning her down, “Help me!”
“Wait!” Scorpia puts her arm out stopping She-Ra from moving forward, “That might not be Catra…”
“What are you guys doing?!” Catra shouts out, “Get Stone!”
Scorpia shakes her head and She-Ra furrows her brow.
“Come on! Help me out here!” Catra shouts as the other Catra grunts under her, trying to get free from her hold, “What is wrong with you fuckwits?!”
“Don’t you dare call them that!” The other Catra growls out, kneeing the magicat hard enough to get her off, before getting off the ground and baring her teeth and claws.
“Catra!” She-Ra shouts out, “We’re coming!”
“Stay back, princess!” Catra shouts out, the real Catra, “Get the cuffs!”
“Oh, right.” She-Ra thinks, “Where are they?!”
“Check Griff!” Catra shouts out as Stone shapeshifts into Adora’s form and smirks at her, “Stop that!”
“No.” Stone says in Adora’s voice, “I like being in this form. It’s

so… tight.”
Catra growls at them as she grabs them up and pushes her back against the wall, eliciting a strange sound of laughter from Adora’s form.
“You like it rough, huh?” Stone says in Adora’s voice coming off flirtatious in a bad way, “Hm… I bet you would like to have her like this, wouldn’t you? Wildcat…”
“Fuck you.” Catra snaps back as Stone slithers out of Catra’s grasp.
“That’s what you want to do to this body… isn’t it?” Stone taunts and slips off the red jacket, dropping it to the ground and promptly turning into nothing but a rag, “How about this? Do you like it when I undress?”
Catra charges forward and Stone moves out of the way easily.
“Nah uh.” Stone taunts again, stepping aside and grinning back at Catra, they look down at their current Adora form and then grins again, “How about this?” they cup their breasts, squeezing them with a salacious look on their face, “I bet you want to touch and play with these.”
“Get out of that form, you sick fuck!” Catra glares at them, ignoring what their hands are doing, “You might look like her, but you’ll never be like her.”
“I am very much like her.” Stone protests with a pout before quirking an eyebrow up at Catra, “What about if I do this?”
Catra charges in again and Stone once again easily dodges her advances, before shoving their hand down into their pants and making some dirty noises, as the magicat lands a solid punch against Stone’s face making them fall down as they’ve only got one hand free.
“Ow! That fucking hurt!” Stone growls out in Adora’s form, their hand out of their pants and now both clenching into fists, “Screw killing your blondie. I’m just going to kill you.”
“Well, are you going to do it or are you going to just talk?” Catra grunts out, “You’re just so full of shit, Stone.”
Stone glares back at Catra, “Like you’re any better than me.”
“I don’t go around killing people for no reason.” Catra replies angrily, “And I don’t go around killing children.”
“You’re still a killer. Killer.” Stone grins through their glare as

Adora, “Whether you like it or not. At least I have to decency to admit that I do it for fun.”
“I don’t kill for fun.” Catra replies back gruffly, “You’re a sick fuck for that very reason.”
“I’m hurt.” Stone feigns hurt from the statement before grinning, “You should definitely try killing for fun.”
“Scorp! Where the fuck are those cuffs?!” Catra shouts out to her friend who seems to be spectating from the sidelines, ignoring Stone’s last taunt, “Help Adora find them!”
“You got it, Wildcat!” Scorpia salutes before running off to help Adora find the cuffs.
As soon as Scorpia is out of sight, Stone grins with Adora’s face and then shapeshifts again, this time into a crocodile. And with that, Catra gets an idea.

“Catra! Where are you going?!” Adora shouts out as she sees Catra running out of the zone and back into to woods and towards the river, “Catra! We got the cuffs! Come back!”
“I’ve got a plan! Trust me!” Catra shouts back as Scorpia and Adora watch the magicat get chased by a large crocodile.
“Where’s Stone?!” Scorpia shouts out.
“Behind me!” Catra replies just as she jumps over the wall and well and truly heads down towards the river.
“Behind her?” Scorpia looks at Adora, scratching her head, “She was being chases by a…”
“A crocodile. Stone’s in that form.” Adora finishes for her, “Come on, we need to follow her.”

Catra sees the river up ahead, her stomach starts to drop as she also sees the masses of reptiles in the shallows, lurking and waiting. Looking behind her, Stone is clearly struggling to chase after her in that form, the movement awkward by anyone that wasn’t born a crocodile as she gets towards the banks, still a good few metres away for comfort but enough to be able to react to an attack from one of the hungry animals in this river.

“Looks like you’ve done yourself a disservice.” Stone growls out, catching their breath as the position themselves up the bank, looking for a way to descend down without falling into the water, “And I thought you were smarter than this.”
“Well, you thought wrong.” Catra returns as she starts to run along the bank to where the area flattens out, which is also very bad in terms of getting to safety if an attack was to come from the water, “Keep up, Stony. Besides like the saying goes, safety dies, reckless kills.”
Stone just snarls back at her as they manage to descent the now manageable bank and get on the same level as Catra, “Maybe I ought to just shove you into the river, let these beasts deal with you.”
Catra stops as a croc makes a lunge at her from the water’s edge, “Fucking hell!” the magicat scrambles back, tripping and falling on her ass as another attack comes from behind her, narrowly missing her tail as she manages to roll out of the way, “Fuck… that was close… ow!”
Stone chomps down on her newly She-Ra healed leg as she starts to jab wildly into the shapeshifter’s eyes. Despite being unable to speak due to her leg being in their mouth, Catra can see the smug look as she gets spun around and gets dragged closer to the water.
“Catra!” Adora calls out as once again her and Scorpia are at the safety of the tree line, helplessly watching on in fear as more surrounding crocodiles appear due to the commotion nearby, “Catra! Hold on! We’re coming!”
“Adora, wait!” Scorpia holds her back, “You’re going to get yourself killed!”
“We have to save her!” Adora shouts back, not caring how close Scorpia’s face is, “We can’t just let her die!”
Scorpia takes a quick moment, furrowing her eyebrows before nodding in agreement, “You’re right. But we can’t just run in there. We are completely outnumbered, and I don’t want to be croc-food.”
“Nor do I.” Adora says as she leaps over the fallen log and runs toward her magicat, “Maybe we can divert their attention.”
“Good thinking.” Scorpia grins, “I’ll go this way, you go that way!”

The pair break off in opposite directions, Adora grabbing a branch and slapping it against the water as she runs up the bank towards Catra, while Scorpia slaps the water with tail before grabbing whatever she can from the bank and throwing it into the water as she runs down the other way and away from Catra.
"Fuck you, Stone!" Catra shouts out jabbing her clawed fingers into their eyes, that act has Stone automatically growling, their mouth opening just wide enough for Catra to yank her leg out and scramble back up the bank, but when she looks around, she's surrounding by snapping jaws, "Shit! Fuck!"
"You're going to pay for that!" Stone growls out angrier than before, their sight blinded and blood bleeds from their eyes as Catra gets to feet, "Come back here, Hunter! Fight me!"
"Yeah, no thanks." Catra grunts out as she tries to hobble away from the snapping jaws and the creatures that keep advancing on her, "I'm good. I think we're good."
The words from Catra make Stone frown up at her in their crocodile form, "What do you mean, we're good?"
"Simple." Catra catches the cuffs from Adora's throw as the blonde gets closer and the magicat slaps one send of the cuffs onto Stone's clawed leg, "I'm done fighting you. In fact…" Catra drops the other side of the cuffs to the ground as Stone is forced to revert back to their original form and when they are back, she charges at them, making the both of them fall into the water.
"Catra!" Adora shouts out, jumping over the snapping jaws of the crocodiles as she rushes into the water and drags Catra out, the magicat splashing around wildly as the blonde throws her over her shoulder and this time, uses the crocs on the banks as stepping stones as she runs back to the safety of the trees, "Catra, hold on."
"Yeah, I am…" Catra splutters out, coughing out water before she turns back to the river and hears Stone screaming as they are completely over taken by reptiles after an easy meal, the magicat winces as Adora gently puts her down onto to wet grass, "Good riddance, Stone." She looks at Adora with a grimace, "Sorry, princess. Guess Bright Moon won't get to punish that jackass."
The sounds of wild splashing, flesh ripping and lack of sound from Stone themselves has Catra doing her best now to avoid looking

at the bloodied water as she winces in pain, staring at Adora who's frowning down at her.
"You did that on purpose!" Adora scolds the magicat before pulling Catra in for a relieved kiss, when they part she slaps the magicat on the shoulder, "What the hell is wrong with you!?"
"What?" Catra complains before she hisses in pain at the slight movement in her leg, "That's not cool, princess. I'm hurt. You're supposed to be nice to hurt people."
"You keep getting into these situations where you almost die!" Adora complains, her eyebrows furrow, "Do you have any idea how stressful it is when the person you love keeps running into dangerous situations?!"
"Woah, what?" Catra moves to sit up, her ears perks right up, "What did you just say?"
Adora continues on her angry rant, "I said, do you have any idea how stressful it is?!"
"No. After that part." Catra says to clarify, shaking over ears out just in case they are still waterlogged, "What was that thing you said about people you… love?"
"I did not say that." Adora tries to backtrack, the red on her face seems to say otherwise, "I said you keep getting yourself into dangerous situations."
Catra smirks, "Busted! You love me…"
Adora groans this time, "That's what you took away from what I said?"
Catra just grins back, despite the pain that's now spreading up her leg, a smirk still on her face as she pulls Adora back down for another kiss, "Must be my charming personality. Isn't it?"
Adora rolls her eyes and presses her lips back onto Catra, "No. Definitely not that."
"Then my rugged good looks." Catra grins wider as she grabs onto Adora's collar to stop herself from falling back to the ground, "I knew it. Chicks dig me."
"Keep talking like that and I'm going to dump you." Adora threatens half heartedly before biting her lip and looking down at Catra nervously.
"What's up, princess?" Catra tilts her head, noticing Adora's awkwardness, her ears flick around thinking maybe there's more

trouble coming before she physically turns her head as well and spots Scorpia on her way towards them, “I love you too, Adora.”
Adora’s eyes widen at the confession before she smiles back, “Thank the stars… I was worried this was one sided…”
“You’re such an idiot.” Catra teases before she lets go of Adora’s jacket and slumps back onto the ground dramatically, “Can you do that thing with my leg again?”
Adora looks down and grimaces. Catra’s pant legs now completely shredded and her leg bloodied to the point where her flesh was coming off the bone, “Oh, stars! That doesn’t look good!”
“Doesn’t feel good either.” Catra replies, her face starting to pale, “Think it might have nicked a major artery…”
The magicat’s eyes roll back as Adora quickly transforms into She-Ra.

“This is humiliating.” Catra groans as Adora carries her into Bright Moon in her arms, “I can limp my way in.”
“No.” Adora sternly says as Scorpia and Entrapta snicker behind them as they get let into the palace doors, “You’re still hurt. I’m not letting you walk.”
“I’m pretty sure I could hitch a ride on Emily or one of Trap’s robots.” Catra tries to argue, but it’s of no use as Adora just shakes her head with a smirk on her face, “You’re totally enjoying this, aren’t you?”
“Yep.” Adora replies happily, “It’s to show that I’m just as strong when I’m not She-Ra.”
“That’s because I’m surprising light.” Catra replies offhandedly.
“Don’t ruin my moment.” Adora chastises, “I’m sick of only being seen to be strong when I’m She-Ra.”
“That seems like a ‘you’ problem.” Catra pouts, “Besides, when we get hitched, I’m going to be the one in the suit and carrying you over the threshold.”
Adora stops, nearly dropping the magicat in her arms, wincing when Catra’s claws dig into the blonde’s shoulders to stop herself from falling, “What did you just say?”
“You heard me, princess.” Catra replies with a smirk, “I’m not repeating myself.”

“Uh huh.” Adora narrows her eyes at the magicat, “We’re not even dating, and you are already proposing marriage…”
“I move fast.” Catra shrugs, “No point in waiting, right?”
“Catra!” Adora groans out as they get to the last of the doors, the guards opening it up to reveal Bow and Glimmer at the throne and waiting for them, “You can’t say stuff like that and not mean it!”
“Who says I don’t mean it?” Catra argues.
“It’s true!’ Entrapta beams from behind, “Catra rarely says anything like this to other romantic partners. She usually doesn’t say anything at all to them. Just huffs and puffs and growls a lot when they get clingy.”
“Awe! Wildcat is growing up so fast!” Scorpia coos as Catra glares back at her friends, “Now I really can’t wait to tell Perfuma!”
“What is going on?!” Glimmer shouts from where she sits, staring at the group that just walked in, “Adora! Why are you carrying that… that…?”
“What Sparkles?” Catra glares back at her, “What am I?”
Bow puts a calming hand on Glimmer’s shoulder, “Glimmer. Remember, Catra’s not the bad guy here.”
Glimmer takes a calming breath in and out, closing her eyes for a moment before reopening them before readdressing Catra, “I’m sorry. I should have said that earlier but you kind of just left and I haven’t had the chance to apologise.”
“Wow. An apology from the queen.” Catra drawls before yelping when Adora jolts her to indicate that she’s being an ass, the magicat glares at Adora who just mirrors it back to her before the magicat rolls her eyes, “Yeah, yeah. Apology accepted or whatever.”
“Good. Great.” Bow claps his hands together, happy that everyone is getting along before looking around, “Where’s Angel?”
“You mean, Stone.” Adora corrects and Bow nods, “They… they…”
“They aren’t going to a problem anymore.” Catra finishes for Adora, “At all.”
“How?” Glimmer asks.
“Crocs ate them.” Catra simply responds before pointing to her leg, “Now, can I get some medical attention and probably something to eat? I’m fucking starving!”

“Yes, yes.” Glimmer nods as her and Bow step forward and bring Adora and thus Catra in for a long overdue hug, “Bring her to the guest room and I’ll get a healer for her.”
“Guest room?” Catra asks looking confused at Adora, “I thought since we’re destined to get hitched, I’d get to bed this princess…”
“Catra!” Adora whines out, “You can’t just say things like that…”
“Yes, I can, because I totally mean them.” Catra cuts her off, “Just like I mean this.”
“What?” Adora manages to get out before the magicat is tugging Adora down to kiss her.
Glimmer makes some childish retching noises, while Bow and Scorpia coo at the sight.
The queen groans, “Gross. Whatever. Go to Adora’s room. But I swear to the stars, if you guys plan to fuck, please close the doors *and* the windows. I don’t want to hear... anything of what you’re planning to do.”
Adora blushes deeply, “We aren’t… I’m not…”
Catra laughs as she grins at Adora, “Yeah, no sex for now. My leg is fucked up as it is and I’m fucking starving. Maybe later.”
Glimmer nods, “Okay.” She clears her throat and smiles at the magicat and her friends, “Welcome to Bright Moon…. I guess.”

Chapter End Notes

...and this is done!

Thank you for sticking with this, even though I got sidetracked a few times...
So... fic 38 is now officially completed! Woop!

Thanks for reading, kudos and comments.
I'm open to ideas for writing other fics if you like my style... otherwise yeah, you'll just have to be surprised with what comes out of this brain of mine.
I'll see you in my current fluff fic then. 😁

End Notes

Thanks for reading!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!